VIETNAM NATIONAL UNIVERSITY, HANOI

INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL

FINAL PROJECT

Lecturer: Nguyen Thi Hong Van Ph.D

Subject: Business Information Systems and Processes

Course: INS203705

Group: 2

Semester: I, 2025-2026

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Hanoi, January 2025

STATEMENT OF COMMITMENT

We so certify that all of the work on this project was created by our group. To the best of our knowledge, every quote, piece of information, and reference utilized in this report has been truthfully presented, appropriately cited, and represents the greatest degree of accuracy. We take full responsibility for the integrity and content of this assignment in the event that any portion of this statement turns out to be false.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

First and foremost, we would like to sincerely thank the instructors at the Vietnam National University-International School for their committed instruction and priceless academic assistance. We would also want to express our sincere gratitude to PhD. Nguyen Thi Hong Van, the instructor of the Business Information Systems and Processes course, for her unwavering support, helpful criticism, and expert insights during the completion of this project.

Under her direction, we developed a more rigorous and disciplined approach to academic work in addition to learning a great lot about information technology and business practices. These lessons will be very helpful in our future academic and career activities.

Lastly, we would like to express our gratitude to our family and friends for their unwavering support, understanding, and encouragement, all of which were crucial to finishing this report successfully.

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MEMBER AND CONTRIBUTION REPORT

Name	Task	Contribution
Nguyễn Thị Đan Phượng	• Introduction • SWOT • Five forces model • Conclusion	100%
Đỗ Quỳnh Anh	• PESTLE • Company's Functional Areas	100%
Lee Yonewoo	Business Model Canvas	100%
Nguyễn Thị Hồng Hạnh	• Cross - functional Business Process • Customer segments and analysis	100%
Nguyễn Thị Phương Mai	V. Describe Information systems (SAPO platform)	100%

I. Introduction

1.1. Problem

Low-quality cosmetics with unclear origins, questionable ingredients, and even counterfeit products are circulating widely. As a result, consumers are increasingly exposed to chemical-heavy formulations that may carry long-term health risks. Research published by Alnuqaydan (2024) in the National Library of Medicine highlights that users of synthetic, chemical-based cosmetics face significantly higher risks of endocrine disruption, cancer, immune system impairment, and other chronic health conditions compared to those using natural alternatives. This reinforces the urgency of addressing product safety in a market where ingredient transparency is still inconsistent.



Figure 1: Low-quality counterfeit chemical-based cosmetics.

Besides, conventional cosmetics also impose a substantial environmental burden. From resource-intensive sourcing and chemical processing to plastic-heavy packaging and animal testing practices, the beauty industry generates considerable waste and pollution across its entire supply chain. According to Golden Arrow (2025), these activities contribute notably to global plastic accumulation, chemical contamination, and the continuation of ethically problematic testing methods.

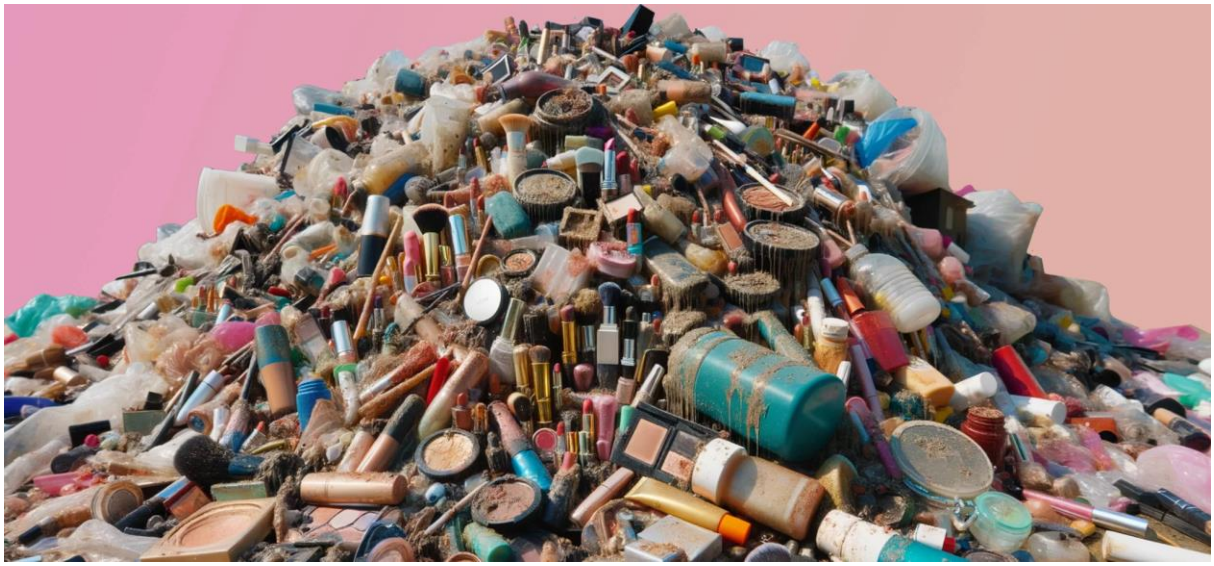


Figure 2: Packaging for cosmetics that uses a lot of plastic has an adverse effect on the environment.

1.2. Purpose

People's health and environmental well-being are foundational to a sustainable society. A beauty industry that compromises both through unsafe ingredients, chemical pollution, and unethical practices cannot support long-term progress.

Lunara aims to address these urgent issues by providing safe, plant-based, cruelty-free cosmetic alternatives that protect both consumers and the environment. Our initial focus is on young Vietnamese consumers, one of the most dynamic and influential segments, who increasingly seek transparent, ethical, and eco-friendly beauty solutions. This group not only drives market trends but also represents the shift toward a healthier and more responsible lifestyle.

1.3. Business Idea Overview

Lunara draws inspiration from two symbolic images: "Luna" - the moon, evoking serenity, renewal, and the quiet rhythm of nature; and "Nara" - a name that carries the sense of purity, harmony, and green vitality. Together, Lunara represents a vision of beauty in balance with nature, where self-care never comes at the expense of the planet or ethical values.



Lunara's mission is *"To empower consumers with gentle, vegan skincare crafted from nature and rooted in honesty"*. Our brand focuses on a streamlined product line built around essential daily routines including facial cleansers, moisturizers, serums, makeup removers, and treatment-focused formulas, all crafted from plant-based ingredients such as coconut oil, green tea, chamomile, aloe vera, shea butter, and matcha. The brand aspires to cultivate a mindful, compassionate, and sustainable beauty routine, while inspiring young Vietnamese consumers to embrace choices that honor both their well-being and the world they live in.

" Lunara is not only a vegan skincare brand, but also a gentle companion for those seeking healthier skin, a kinder lifestyle, and a more mindful way of caring for themselves and the planet every day."

Lunara operates primarily through digital channels, leveraging e-commerce platforms and social media to reach a generation that values convenience, authenticity, and transparency. At its core, Lunara aims to cultivate a mindful, cruelty-free, and sustainable approach to beauty. The brand seeks not only to offer safe and effective skincare, but also to become a gentle companion for those pursuing healthier skin, a kinder lifestyle, and a more conscious daily routine, one that respects both personal well-being and the world they live in.

1.4. Brand Identity & Core Values

LUNARA's brand identity is built around simplicity, ethics, and natural care. The brand adopts a minimalist and nature-inspired visual style to communicate purity, calmness, and trust. Soft color tones, clean packaging, and uncluttered design reflect LUNARA's commitment to

gentle skincare and transparency, reinforcing the idea that beauty should be safe, honest, and approachable rather than exaggerated or trend-driven.

At the core of LUNARA's identity are values that guide both business decisions and customer engagement. The brand is firmly committed to vegan and cruelty-free principles, ingredient transparency, and environmental responsibility. LUNARA's personality can be described as gentle, elegant, and honest, shaping its tone of voice, marketing communication, and customer interactions. These core values ensure consistency across product development, digital communication, and customer experience, enabling LUNARA to build long-term trust and emotional connection with Vietnamese consumers.

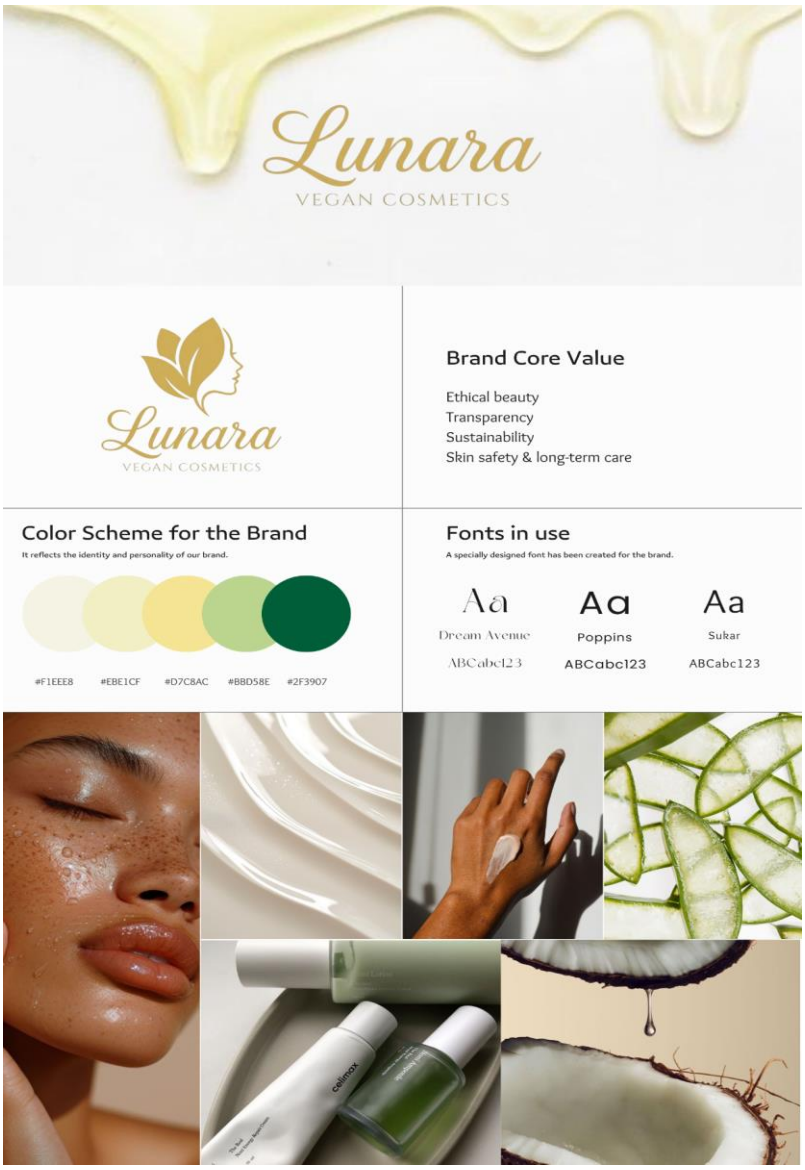


Figure 3: Lunara's Brand Board

Lunara's Website: https://portfolionguyenthidanphuong.my.canva.site/group-2-lunara-website

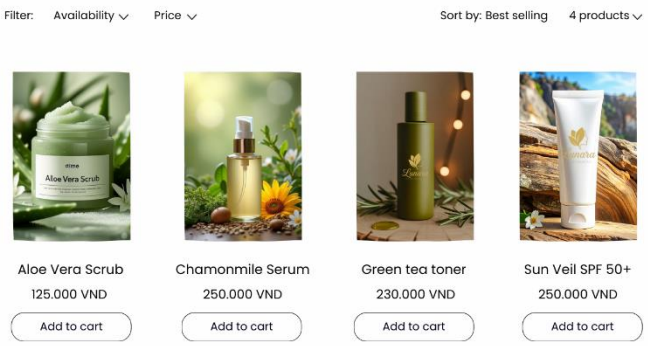




Our Story

LUNARA was created with a gentle promise to care for your skin with honesty, kindness, and respect for nature. Rooted in vegan and cruelty-free values, we believe beauty should feel calm, effortless, and true to who you are.

Inspired by nature and crafted with care, LUNARA offers minimalist skincare made for modern, conscious women who choose softness over excess and simplicity over exaggeration.



New Collection

Bringing the calming power of nature into your everyday ritual

SHOP NOW



CERTIFIED BY INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATION

PETA

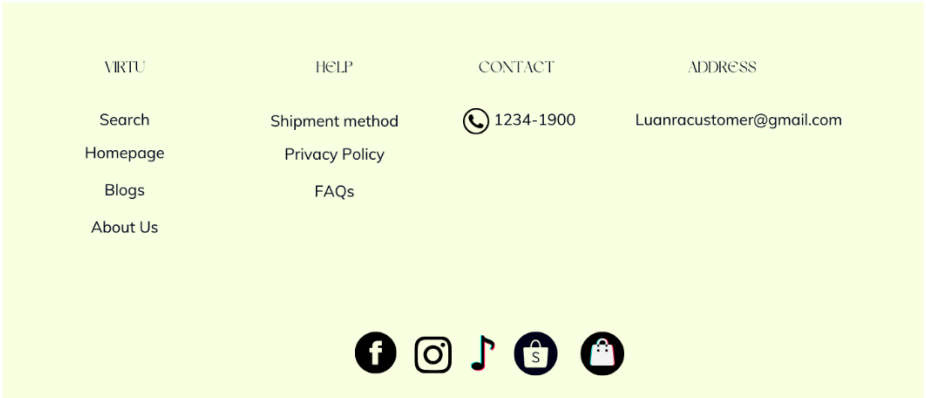
A globally recognized organization dedicated to protecting animal rights and promoting cruelty-free practices worldwide.

THE VEGAN SOCIETY

An international nonprofit organization that defines and promotes vegan standards across food, lifestyle, and consumer products

ANIMAL TEST FREE-VEGAN

Verifies that products are free from animal testing and contain no animal-derived ingredients



II. Market and Strategic Analysis

2.1. SWOT

2.1.1 Strengths

- **Plant-based, vegan, and skin-friendly formulations:** Lunara's products are built on familiar Vietnamese plant ingredients such as coconut oil, green tea, chamomile, aloe vera, shea butter, and matcha. These ingredients are naturally soothing, low-irritation, and well-suited to Vietnam's climate, helping the brand establish trust in safety and natural efficacy.
- **Strong commitment to ingredient and process transparency:** Lunara openly discloses full ingredient lists, sourcing origins, safety standards, and avoids harsh synthetic fragrances, parabens, and high-risk chemicals. This directly addresses a major pain point in the Vietnamese market, where counterfeit and non-transparent products are common.
- **Affordable-premium pricing strategy:** Instead of positioning itself as an exclusive high-end brand, Lunara offers accessible pricing for students and young professionals, a segment that values clean beauty but remains cost-sensitive. This approach expands market reach while maintaining cruelty-free, plant-based quality.
- **Sustainable and eco-conscious packaging:** Lunara prioritizes recyclable materials, reduced-plastic designs, and potential refillable options. This aligns strongly with the rising environmental awareness among Vietnamese Gen Z consumers and differentiates Lunara from local brands still relying on conventional plastic packaging.
- **Genuine cruelty-free positioning:** While many Vietnamese brands loosely claim natural or ethical values, few commit to authentic cruelty-free standards. Lunara can leverage this as a key differentiator for young consumers who increasingly prioritize ethical consumption and animal welfare.

2.1.2 Weaknesses

- **Slower visible results due to natural formulations:** Because Lunara relies on plant-based ingredients rather than fast-acting synthetic chemicals, product effects may appear more gradually. This can be a disadvantage in a market where many consumers expect quick, dramatic results, especially in categories like whitening or acne treatment.

- **Weaker brand presence compared to established competitors:** As a new vegan beauty brand, Lunara faces an inherent disadvantage in visibility and trust when competing with long-established domestic and international giants. Limited brand recognition can slow early-stage adoption.
- **Narrow product portfolio:** Lunara's offerings are currently concentrated in skincare, with limited extension into haircare, bodycare, or specialized treatments. This lack of diversification restricts cross-selling opportunities and reduces competitiveness against full-range beauty brands.
- **Higher production costs:** Using high-quality plant-derived ingredients, more careful extraction processes, and cruelty-free standards typically leads to higher production costs compared to brands using cheap synthetic chemicals. This can affect pricing strategies and reduce profit margins, a challenge commonly observed among vegan or premium beauty brands (Business Research Insights, 2024).

2.1.3 Opportunities

- **Rapid Vietnamese growth of the vegan cosmetics market:** The global vegan cosmetics market was valued at roughly US$19.21 billion in 2024 and is projected to grow to US$32.56 billion by 2032, with a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 6.85% (Business Research Insights, 2024)

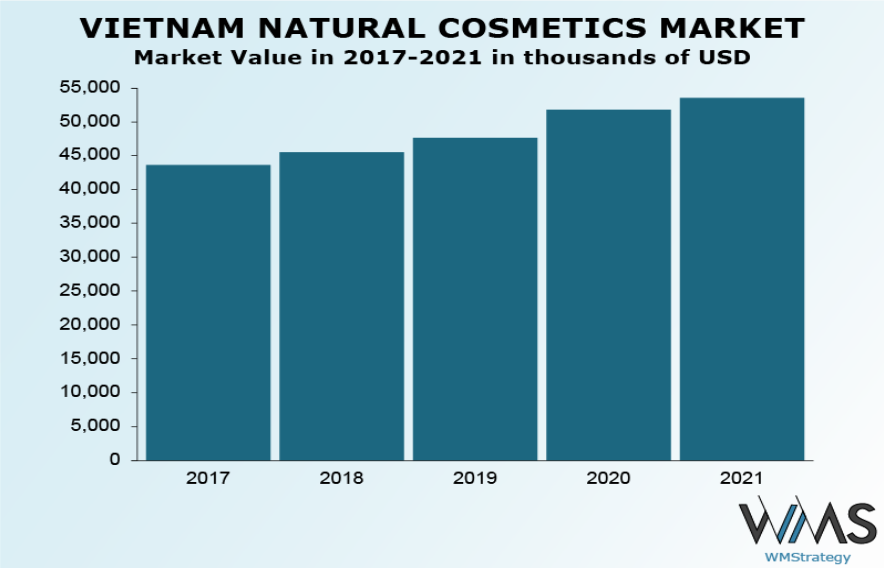


Figure 4: Vietnam natural cosmetics market value in 2017-2021

Source: Reshovski, (2023)

- **Rising demand for "natural/clean" options in Vietnam:** The demand for natural, clean, and health-oriented beauty products is rising sharply as Vietnamese consumers increasingly adopt global sustainability and wellness trends. This shift mirrors broader international patterns: a McKinsey consumer study found that 75% of respondents intend to maintain healthier lifestyle habits, while 24% prioritize products made with eco-friendly ingredients and recyclable packaging, indicating a clear move toward cleaner and more responsible consumption (McKinsey & Company, 2023). As Vietnam's young consumers become more health-conscious and ingredient-aware, brands like Lunara built on plant-based, cruelty-free, and environmentally gentle values, are well positioned to meet this growing preference for "clean beauty."
- **Rapid growth of e-commerce & online beauty sales in Vietnam:** The beauty category in Vietnam's e-commerce ecosystem continues to grow fast. According to a recent report, on online retail platforms, cosmetics sales are rising, signaling that direct-to-consumer (D2C) or online-first brands can scale efficiently. Particularly, after covid 19, Vietnamese consumer are more likely to consume products online (Das et al., 2023)

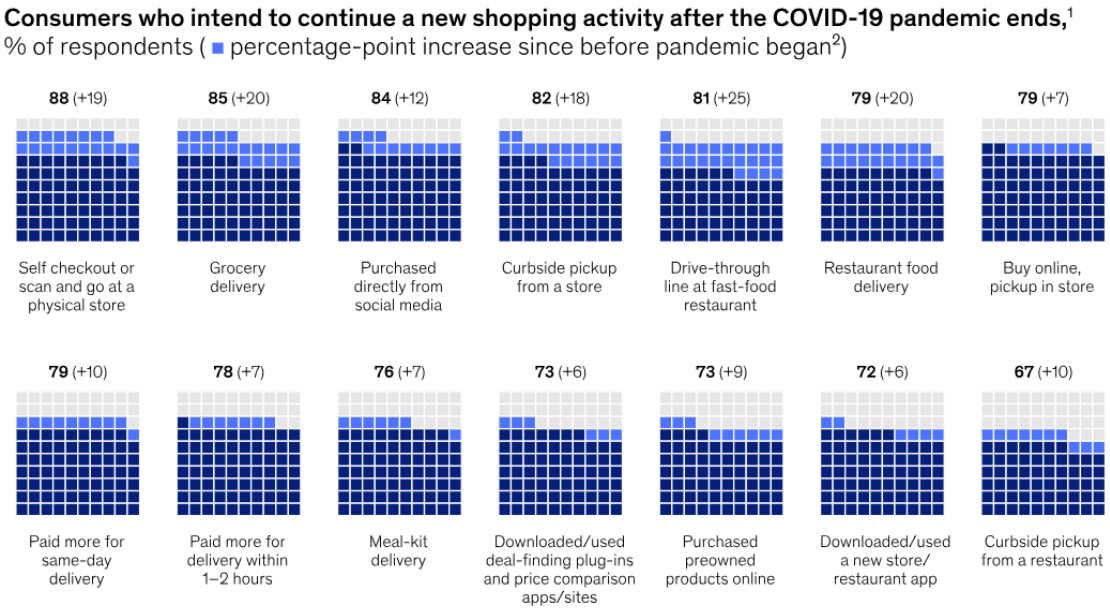


Figure 5: More than 65% of Vietnamese consumers intend to use alternative methods to in-store shopping postpandemic

Source: Das et al., (2023)

2.1.4 Threats

- **Intense market competition**: Vietnam's cosmetic market is dominated by major international players, which still hold around 90% market share (Le Quynh Anh, 2024). This puts strong pressure on emerging local brands like Lunara to stand out and gain consumer trust.
- **High standards for certification and quality control**: To remain credible as a cruelty-free, plant-based, and transparent brand, Lunara must adhere to strict regulatory requirements, safety testing, and ingredient verification. Any lapse can trigger consumer skepticism or negative reactions.
- **Supply chain risks for natural ingredients**: Plant-based raw materials often face volatility in price, seasonal limitations, and inconsistent quality. These fluctuations can disrupt production, increase costs, and negatively impact product consistency and brand reputation.

2.2. Five Forces Model

2.2.1. Threat of New Entrants - Moderate to High

Entering Vietnam's beauty and skincare market comes with relatively low barriers. The rise of e-commerce, affordable digital branding, and strong market growth enables small brands to launch quickly via social media and online platforms. The beauty and personal care market in Vietnam is projected to reach approximately USD 2.74 billion by 2025, with a forecasted compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 3.26% from 2025 to 2029 (Statista, 2025). This momentum attracts a steady wave of new players, increasing the overall threat of new entrants.

However, long-term survival is significantly harder. Brands must invest in high-quality formulations, safety testing, transparent ingredient sourcing, and stable plant-based supply chains. These requirements create a moderate barrier to sustained growth, but not enough to prevent a continual influx of indie and online-only brands competing for attention.

2.2.2. Bargaining Power of Suppliers - Moderate

Vietnam's supplier landscape gives Lunara both advantages and constraints. The country has relatively affordable organic and herbal raw materials, with native ingredients like coconut, turmeric, green tea, and aloe vera widely cultivated - particularly coconut in the Mekong Delta

(Briefing, 2023). This agricultural diversity provides Lunara with multiple domestic sourcing options, helping prevent over-dependence on a single supplier.

However, plant-based ingredients such as botanical oils and extracts remain sensitive to seasonality, climate variability, and quality fluctuations. High-grade, certified vegan or cruelty-free extracts - especially chamomile, shea butter, or premium matcha - are often produced by a smaller number of trusted suppliers, giving these suppliers stronger negotiating power. As a result, while Vietnam's abundant natural resources lower overall supplier concentration, the need for consistent quality and certification keeps the bargaining power of suppliers at a moderate level

2.2.3. Bargaining Power of Buyers - High

Consumers in Vietnam now face an abundance of choices, ranging from low-cost local brands to premium international labels, K-beauty imports, Japanese skincare, and even handmade or indie products. Switching between brands is extremely easy and involves almost no cost, which strengthens buyer bargaining power. According to Statista (2025), Vietnam's imported cosmetics market is dominated by products from South Korea, followed by France, Japan, and the United States further widening the pool of alternatives available to customers.

At the same time, the rise of clean, vegan, and ingredient-conscious beauty has made consumers far more demanding. They expect transparency about formulations, sourcing, safety, and cruelty-free practices. If a brand fails to meet these expectations, shoppers can quickly shift to another option. While global interest in vegan skincare and cruelty-free cosmetics continues to surge, this growing demand also heightens pressure on brands like Lunara to maintain quality, keep prices competitive, and communicate clearly. The result is a marketplace where buyers hold significant power, driven by variety, low switching costs, and elevated expectations.

2.2.4. Threat of Substitutes - Moderate

The beauty and personal care market in Vietnam is highly fluid, and consumers face a wide spectrum of alternatives. Substitutes for Lunara include conventional chemical-based cosmetics, mass-market international brands, affordable local products, treatment-based services and even DIY natural skincare such as aloe vera, coconut oil, green tea, or homemade masks. These options are often cheaper, widely accessible, and can deliver fast or visible results, especially for consumers who prioritize convenience and immediate effectiveness.

For this large group of "non-philosophical" users, switching costs are extremely low. They do not commit to any ethical principle like veganism or sustainability; if a product does not meet expectations in quality, price, or performance, they readily migrate to another brand. This pushes the threat of substitutes upward.

However, the vegan and clean beauty segment is also growing in Vietnam. A rising share of customers actively seek cruelty-free, ingredient-transparent, and environmentally responsible products. For these value-driven consumers, non-vegan or non-clean alternatives are less attractive. Their stronger loyalty helps counterbalance the easy-switching behavior of the wider market. Given this dual reality, high substitutability for mainstream users but stronger stickiness among ethical consumers, the overall threat of substitutes falls into the moderate range. Alternatives certainly exist and are easily accessible, but they do not fully erode the appeal of vegan, plant-based, and cruelty-free products for a meaningful portion of the market.

2.2.5. Industry Rivalry - Very High

The Vietnamese cosmetics market is intensely competitive, with a large market size. This steady expansion attracts a constant flow of both domestic and international players, making the landscape increasingly crowded. While imported brands, especially from South Korea, Japan, France, and the U.S. continue to dominate premium and mid-range segments, local brands have been rising quickly. Natural, clean-beauty, and vegan-leaning labels such as Cocoon or Cỏ Mềm Homelab have built strong traction by leveraging social media, e-commerce platforms, and relatable marketing styles tailored to young Vietnamese consumers. Their competitive pricing and proximity to local ingredient sources give them additional advantages.

The continuous entry of new brands, combined with aggressive competition in pricing, product innovation, packaging, influencer marketing, and distribution channels, places heavy pressure on all players. For Lunara, this means rivalry is extremely intense. Companies compete not only for market share but also for visibility, credibility, and differentiation within a fast-moving and trend-driven industry.

2.3. PESTLE

2.3.1 Political

The political stability in Vietnam provides a solid foundational environment for LUNARA's growth. However, the political factor is most evident through increasingly stringent regulations concerning quality and transparency in the cosmetics industry, which LUNARA can strategically leverage as a core competitive advantage.

Policies set forth by the Ministry of Health and drug administration agencies demand heightened transparency, supporting LUNARA in utilizing compliance as a market differentiator like the first one is circular 06/2011/TT-BYT: This foundational legal document governs cosmetics management, encompassing product notification and the Product Information File (PIF), as well as the responsibilities of entities marketing cosmetics. LUNARA must establish a detailed PIF management system, particularly to substantiate the vegan and organic origins of every raw material batch. The next one is Good Manufacturing Practices (GMP-ASEAN) Standards: Production facilities are required to meet GMP standards to ensure quality and hygiene. LUNARA must invest in a closed production process, preventing cross-contamination with non-vegan ingredients. Achieving GMP is a mandatory element for maintaining quality trust in the market.(Drug Administration of Vietnam (Ministry of Health)).

International trade policies and government support for technology adoption create cost-optimization opportunities for LUNARA. According to the EVFTA Agreement (EU – Vietnam), the reduction in import tariffs on materials from the EU allows LUNARA to easily procure certified organic extracts and active ingredients (which are typically high-cost) with lower expenditure. This enhances the competitive pricing advantage in the Affordable-premium segment while ensuring unique, high-quality standards. Startup and E-commerce Encouragement Policies: The government promotes digital transformation and e-commerce development (Decree 52/2013/ND-CP on e-commerce). This creates a favorable environment for LUNARA to expand its D2C (Direct-to-Consumer) channels (Website, E-commerce Marketplaces) and optimize logistics.

2.3.2. Economic

Vietnam's economy continues to maintain strong growth momentum, creating a solid foundation for the expansion of the consumer market. This development boosts income,

particularly in major economic centers, leading to a significant expansion of the middle class. According to the latest regulations effective from July 1, 2024, the regional minimum wage has increased by 6%, ranging from 3,450,000 VND (Region IV) to 4,960,000 VND (Region I). Notably, in key urban centers such as Ho Chi Minh City, most districts (with the exception of Can Gio, which falls under Region II) apply the Region I wage level (Expertis, 2021). This improvement in income is the main driving force behind a young customer base with high purchasing power who are willing to spend on products (Euromonitor International, Beauty and Personal Care Vietnam Report, 2025). This shift supports the trend of conscious consumption, where customers seek health values and ethical aesthetics. LUNARA has a great opportunity to capitalize on this change in individual spending behavior.

LUNARA must also face risks from macroeconomic fluctuations. According to People's Army Newspaper, Vietnam's inflation rate is projected to stabilize at 3.5-4.5% in 2025. However, when accounting for domestic wage increases and logistics volatility, a realistic operational range of 3.5% - 4.0% is expected (DKSH, 2025). This trend directly impacts operating costs - specifically logistics, raw materials, and labor, putting pressure on LUNARA's profit margins. Additionally, with the VND/USD exchange rate projected due to global monetary shifts (World Bank, 2025), LUNARA must implement. Currency Hedging: Utilizing financial instruments to lock in exchange rates for any imported ingredients or specialized equipment. Supply Chain Optimization: Increasing the ratio of domestic sourcing to reduce reliance on foreign currency and minimize cross-border logistics costs.

2.3.3. Social – Cultural

The social and cultural factor acts as a major driver for the Clean Beauty industry and forms the foundation of LUNARA's positioning strategy. Vietnam possesses a young population structure, creating a large target customer base, particularly Gen Z, who are quick to adapt to global trends and tend to be discerning consumers. As a result, customers are becoming more sensitive about quality and health, viewing skincare as an essential part of a healthy lifestyle.

According to the market research report on Skin Care Products in Vietnam published by Expert Market Research (EMR), this market is showing strong growth momentum and significant potential. The report estimates the size of the Vietnam skin care products market to have reached approximately USD 1.20 billion in 2024. In the forecast period from 2025 to 2034, the market is projected to grow at a Compound Annual Growth Rate (CAGR) of 9.50%, expected to reach a

value of around USD 2.97 billion by 2034. This growth is driven by a young population with high awareness of skincare, the rise of e-commerce and social media platforms, along with the trend of seeking natural, organic products and personalized skincare solutions. The report also highlights a significant shift in the market: the increasing demand for skincare products from the male customer segment, a new driving force for domestic and international product suppliers. (Expert Market Research - Phân tích Tăng trưởng, Xu hướng và Triển vọng Dự báo (2025-2034))

More importantly, Gen Z is leading the trend of Ethical Consumption, where the brand's ethical values are as important as the product's quality. LUNARA gains a strong competitive advantage by positioning itself as a safe, natural, and ethical skincare solution, contrasting with conventional beauty products that lack transparency.

2.3.4. Technological

Technology serves as the backbone for LUNARA's operations and marketing. The strong development of e-commerce and social media platforms provides effective means to reach young audiences, educate the market on ingredient transparency, and communicate brand values. Many consumers now use mobile apps to track skincare habits and search for product information. LUNARA can leverage this trend by creating a digital ecosystem (through its Website and Sapo CRM) linked to wellness and customer experience. Integrating smart technologies into order management, customer support, and logistics helps LUNARA achieve a significant competitive edge and deliver a seamless customer experience.

LUNARA leverages Transparency Technology by integrating QR codes and digital labeling on all product packaging. This allows consumers to instantly access comprehensive data regarding ingredient sourcing, clinical certifications, and production timelines. By providing "proof of origin" at the touch of a button, LUNARA effectively builds long-term consumer trust in an era of information transparency.

Furthermore, according to the e-Conomy SEA 2025 report, Vietnam's digital economy is projected to reach US$39 billion by 2025, leading Southeast Asia in terms of AI adoption and user trust. (Google, 2025) Therefore, LUNARA deploys AI-powered tools, including an advanced AI chatbot for personalized 24/7 skincare advice and automated Q&A. Beyond customer service, AI analytics is used to measure marketing effectiveness across platforms, enabling real-time content adjustments and budget allocation based on consumer interaction patterns.

With the explosion of e-commerce platforms like TikTok and Shopee, which have changed shopping behavior, LUNARA has adopted live streaming technology as a sales channel (Metric, 2025). By actively selling on TikTok Shop and Shopee Live, the brand interacts directly with Gen Z and Millennials. This "entertainment shopping" approach, combined with instant purchases, creates a sales channel with a high conversion rate.

These front-end technologies are seamlessly linked to a robust back-end ecosystem through the Website and Sapo CRM. This integration ensures that data from social commerce, AI interactions, and logistics are centralized, helping LUNARA achieve a significant competitive edge through a seamless, omnichannel customer experience.

2.3.5. Environmental

The environmental consciousness of Vietnamese consumers is increasing, prioritizing sustainable and eco-friendly options. This is a strategic opportunity for LUNARA to invest in recycled packaging, plastic waste reduction, and implementing packaging take-back/recycling programs. However, climate change and weather instability (such as droughts and floods) pose a potential threat to the domestic supply of natural raw materials. LUNARA needs to invest in building a diverse, sustainable, and resilient supply chain, while fostering strategic cooperation with organic, safe farms to ensure the quality of its input materials.

Approximately 90% of Vietnamese consumers prefer sustainable brands when price and quality are comparable (Q&Me, 2025). LUNARA leverages this by investing in recycled packaging, reducing plastic waste, and implementing packaging recovery/recycling programs. These initiatives foster long-term customer loyalty and align with Vietnam's National Green Growth Strategy to 2030.

Recognizing that water can account for up to 70-80% of traditional cosmetic formulations (DKSH, 2024). Waterless formulation innovation: Developing "low-water" or powder formulations to minimize environmental impact, extend shelf life without harsh preservatives, and reduce emissions during shipping due to lighter weight. Compliance with OEM water standards: Exclusive cooperation with ISO-certified (OEM/ODM) manufacturers applying advanced wastewater treatment systems to ensure no polluting discharge, meeting stricter environmental regulations expected by 2026.

Vietnam remains at high risk of natural disasters due to climate change (drought and saltwater intrusion), directly threatening the domestic supply of natural raw materials (World Bank, 2025). To mitigate this, LUNARA implements a "Diverse Sourcing Strategy," fostering strategic partnerships with organic farms using regenerative agriculture to ensure consistent raw material quality despite weather fluctuations.

2.3.6. Legal

The legal and regulatory environment plays a critical role in shaping the operations of cosmetic businesses in Vietnam. The following table summarizes the key legal regulations that directly impact LUNARA's product development, marketing activities, and brand protection:

Table 1: Product & Advertising Law in Vietnam

Key Legal Document	**Specific Impact on LUNARA**
Decree 181/2013/NĐ-CP (and amendments)	Strictly regulates cosmetics advertising. LUNARA must ensure all claims about product efficacy (e.g., "soothes sensitive skin") are substantiated by scientific evidence and the Product Information File (PIF). Prohibited from using terms like "cure" or "treat" which are reserved for pharmaceuticals.
Law on Protection of Consumer Rights (2010)	Obligates LUNARA to provide transparent and accurate information regarding ingredients, expiration dates, and usage instructions. All information on packaging must align with the public product notification dossier.
Law on Intellectual Property (2005)	Protects LUNARA's brand name, logo, and proprietary formulas from being copied or counterfeited. Trademark registration in Vietnam and internationally (if pursuing export) is essential.

Table 2: Tax and Accounting Legislation

Tax/Obligation Type	Specific Impact on LUNARA
Value Added Tax (VAT)	Currently 10\% for most products. LUNARA must strictly manage input/output invoices, especially during periods when the government implements VAT reduction programs.
Corporate Income Tax (CIT)	The standard tax rate is 20\%. Need to manage Cost of Goods Sold (COGS) and ensure all claimed expenses (e.g., Cruelty-free certification costs, Marketing expenses) are reasonable and legitimate to optimize tax obligations.
Personal Income Tax (PIT) & Insurance	Ensure full compliance with PIT withholding and the mandatory payment of social insurance (BHXH, BHYT) for employees, particularly for sales and production teams. (General Department of Taxation (GDT), Ministry of Finance.)

Strict adherence to these legal frameworks not only helps LUNARA avoid administrative penalties but also reinforces its image as a responsible, trustworthy, and transparent brand.

2.4. Customer segments and analysis

Customer segmentation plays a vital role in enabling Lunara to understand the diversity of consumer needs within the vegan skincare and clean beauty industry. As the Vietnamese market grows rapidly, consumer behavior becomes increasingly sophisticated, shaped by expectations around safety, ingredient transparency, and sustainability. Identifying the right segments allows Lunara to design relevant strategies, optimize resource allocation, and strengthen long-term competitive advantage.

2.4.1. Primary Customer Segments

- ***Segment 1: Gen Z – Ingredient-Conscious and Trend-Sensitive (Age 16–25)***

Gen Z is the most influential demographic shaping beauty trends today. According to McKinsey (2023), 79% of Gen Z consumers in Asia prefer natural, sustainable, and ethically aligned beauty products, reflecting a shift in how younger generations perceive skincare.

Detailed behaviors:

- Actively research ingredient lists before purchasing
- Prioritize clean, gentle, vegan-friendly formulas
- Strongly influenced by TikTok creators and online testimonials
- Prefer affordable-premium price ranges
- Value eco-friendly and minimalist packaging

Strategic relevance: This segment is critical for Lunara's brand awareness and engagement due to its active presence on social media.

- ***Segment 2: Young Working Professionals – Safety-Oriented and Convenience-Focused (Age 23–35)***

This group has stable income and spends significantly on skincare due to lifestyle pressures such as pollution, stress, and lack of time. NielsenIQ (2023) highlights that over 60% of young professionals in Vietnam now prefer gentle, irritation-free skincare products.

Detailed behaviors:

- Purchase through multiple channels: e-commerce, TikTok Shop, brand website
- Loyalty increases with trust and product effectiveness
- Willing to pay premium prices for natural ingredients
- Expect professional packaging and reliable results
- Favor simple routines with scientifically backed formulas

Strategic relevance: This is Lunara's most valuable segment, offering high customer lifetime value and consistent revenue.

- ***Segment 3: Eco-Conscious Lifestyle Consumers (Age 25–40)***

These consumers make purchase decisions based on personal values, especially environmental responsibility. GlobalData (2024) reports that 41% of Vietnamese consumers are willing to spend more on sustainable products.

Detailed behaviors:

- Prefer recyclable or refillable packaging
- Seek transparency regarding sourcing and manufacturing
- Respond strongly to sustainability-driven messaging
- Support brands aligned with ethical commitments

Strategic relevance: While smaller, this segment enhances Lunara's credibility and positioning as a responsible vegan skincare brand.

- ***Segment 4: Sensitive-Skin Consumers – Reliability and Safety First***

According to Statista (2024), 35% of Vietnamese consumers have sensitive or irritation-prone skin, creating strong demand for gentle formulations.

Detailed behaviors:

- Avoid alcohol, synthetic fragrance, parabens
- Carefully examine ingredient lists
- Prefer dermatologically tested formulas
- Once satisfied, exhibit strong repeat-purchase behavior

Strategic relevance: This is one of Lunara's most loyal segments, contributing significantly to repeat revenue.

2.4.2. Behavioral and Psychographic Insights

Across the four segments, Lunara identifies several common behavioral patterns:

- High interest in ingredient transparency due to concerns about counterfeit and chemical-heavy cosmetics.
- Preference for digital purchasing, driven by the rise of e-commerce and social media influence post-COVID-19.
- Increasing value placed on ethical consumption, particularly cruelty-free and natural ingredients.
- Demand for reliable information and personalized skincare, motivating customers to engage with brand content and CRM-based advice.

These insights emphasize that Lunara's customers are not only product-driven but also emotionally and ethically motivated, seeking brands that reflect their values and lifestyle choices.

2.4.3. Value Contribution and Customer Prioritization

Following the identification of customer characteristics, motivations, and behavioral patterns, the next essential step is to evaluate the value contribution of each customer segment to Lunara's business objectives. This analysis enables the brand to determine which segments generate the highest returns, which groups should be prioritized for retention, and which segments hold strong potential for future expansion. Understanding the relative contribution of each segment allows Lunara to allocate resources more effectively and develop strategic initiatives that support sustainable long-term growth.

Segment	Contribution	Long-Term Potential	Loyalty Level
Gen Z	Awareness & virality	High	Medium
Office workers	Stable revenue & high CLV	Very high	High
Eco-lifestyle users	Brand credibility	High	High
Sensitive skin users	Strong repeat purchases	Very high	Very high

2.4.4. Strategic Implications for Lunara

Based on the segmentation and analysis above, LUNARA should prioritize the development of affordable-premium pricing tiers that align with Gen Z's purchasing power while maintaining high standards of product quality and transparency. The brand should also strengthen its digital marketing and omnichannel presence, with a particular focus on TikTok, Instagram, Shopee, and the official brand website to effectively engage target customers across multiple touchpoints. In addition, enhancing CRM-based personalization will allow LUNARA to better serve high-value segments such as working professionals and consumers with sensitive skin. Continued investment in sustainable packaging, cruelty-free commitments, and educational content is essential to maintain credibility and resonance with eco-conscious consumers. Finally,

leveraging structured customer feedback loops will enable LUNARA to continuously refine product formulations and ensure they respond to real user needs and preferences.

III. Business Model Canvas

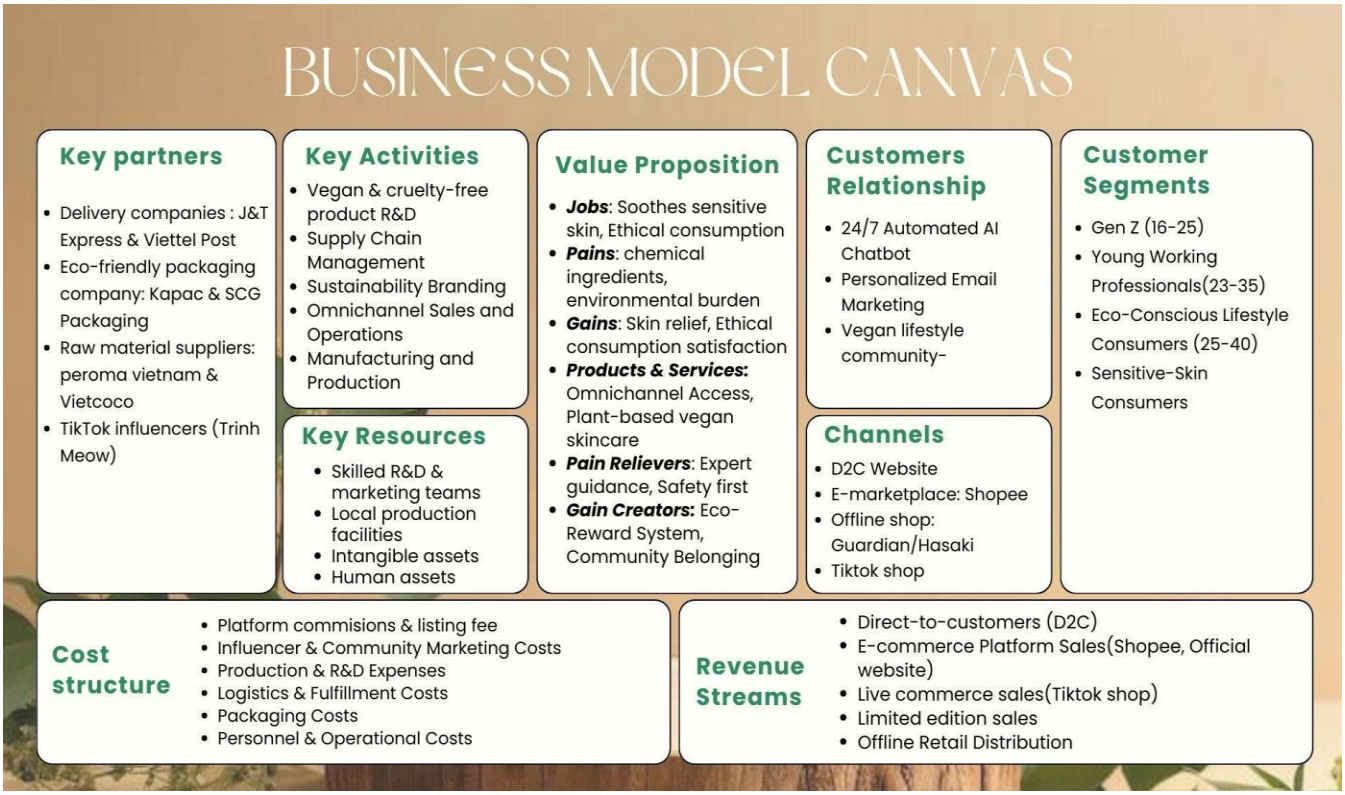


Figure 6: Lunara's Business Model Canvas

3.1 Customer Segments

Based on the previous customer segmentation analysis, this section integrates the identified customer groups into the Business Model Canvas to illustrate their role within LUNARA's business processes and information systems.

- **Gen Z – Ingredient-Conscious and Trend-Sensitive (16–25)**

Comprised of college students and young professionals, this group meticulously reviews ingredient lists and prioritizes gentle, vegan formulas. They are heavily influenced by TikTok creators and online reviews, favoring affordable premium price points and eco-friendly, minimalist packaging. They actively share brand stories on social media, serving as a key driver of viral marketing.

- **Young Professionals – Safety-Oriented and Convenience-Oriented (23–35)**

This group, with stable incomes, is willing to spend heavily on skincare due to urban pollution and stress. They conveniently shop through various channels, including e-commerce, TikTok Shop, and brand websites, and are willing to pay a premium for natural ingredients. They prefer simple, scientifically proven routines, and as they build trust and product effectiveness, they are the most valuable segment, delivering high customer lifetime value.

- **Eco-Conscious Lifestyle Consumers (25–40)**

Prioritizing personal values and environmental responsibility, these consumers prefer recyclable/refillable packaging. They demand transparency in raw material sourcing and manufacturing processes, and they respond strongly to sustainability messages and campaigns. While small in size, they play a crucial role in strengthening Lunara's eco-friendly and vegan brand image and building trust.

- **Consumers with Sensitive Skin – Reliability and Safety Prioritized**

This group avoids chemicals like alcohol, synthetic fragrances, and parabens. They prefer hypoallergenic and dermatologically tested formulas, and once satisfied, they show a very high repurchase rate. Lunara's 100% plant-based, hypoallergenic formula is a key segment that drives long-term loyalty.

3.2 Value Propositions

- **Customer Profile**

Jobs: Customers want to maintain healthy, clear, and clean skin every day, especially for sensitive skin, while maintaining safe, non-irritating care. At the same time, they strive to cultivate a beauty lifestyle that aligns with their values by practicing ethical consumption practices that avoid animal testing and harm the environment. They desire to feel fulfilled in their daily lives by making choices that protect their skin and the environment, rather than simply purchasing products.

Pains: They repeatedly experience skin irritations like redness, itchiness, and breakouts from using cosmetics containing conventional chemical ingredients (synthetic fragrances, parabens, alcohol, etc.), and they struggle with ingredient anxiety about which products to trust.

They often feel guilty about contributing to environmental destruction when choosing brands with excessive plastic packaging, and they frequently waste time and money buying products that don't suit them. Finding the right routine for them, especially among the numerous products available, can be complex and challenging.

Gains: They desire personalized skincare routines tailored to their skin type and concerns through expert consultations, resulting in quick and effective skin improvement and a sense of daily peace of mind. We want our customers to experience comfort without worrying about skin irritation by using products made with 100% natural ingredients, and to feel the moral satisfaction and pride of choosing a vegan and cruelty-free brand. Furthermore, we strive to build long-term emotional bonds with our brand by connecting with a community that shares our values, sharing empathy and inspiration.

- **Value Map**

Products & Services: We offer a multi-channel shopping experience through our official Shopee store, TikTok Shop, and official website, allowing them to conveniently search and purchase products anytime, anywhere. Gen Z discovers and purchases on TikTok, while young professionals can order from their mobile devices during their commute. We offer a full line of products, including 100% plant-based, vegan, and cruelty-free certified skincare products, featuring gentle formulas centered around local Vietnamese ingredients like coconut oil. Furthermore, we offer a personalized skin diagnosis service where customers submit photos and a questionnaire through our website and social media. Our team of experts conducts a one-on-one analysis of their skin type and current concerns, recommending the optimal product combination and application sequence.

Pain Relievers: Our 24/7 automated chatbot provides immediate tracking of orders, product inquiries, and basic usage instructions. When needed, it connects you to a professional consultant to completely resolve complex selection issues. All products disclose the percentage of organic ingredients, are dermatologically tested for hypoallergenicity, and are guaranteed to be free of harmful ingredients, eliminating the risk of chemical ingredients or skin irritation. Pre-purchase sample kits eliminate the risk of failure, wondering, "Will this product suit my skin?"

Gain Creators: We run an ongoing bottle take-back campaign where customers can earn points by returning empty containers in-store or via courier, which can be used as discount coupons

for their next purchase. Customers experience both economic benefits and a sense of fulfillment in contributing directly to environmental protection, encouraging continued participation and repeat purchases. The official "Vegan Lifestyle Community" facilitates the sharing of vegan skincare tips, sustainable lifestyle content, and experiences among members. Connecting with like-minded individuals fosters a sense of belonging and empathy.

3.3 Channels

Lunara's omnichannel approach, combining online-centric D2C, social commerce, and offline experience centers, allows customers to seamlessly discover and purchase products wherever they are.

Official Website: Direct-to-Consumer (D2C) Store: Lunara sells 100% vegan cosmetics directly through its official website, safely collecting and protecting first-party customer data. This allows brands to strengthen direct relationships with customers and realize high margins.

Shopee: Lunara operates an official store on Shopee, Vietnam's largest e-commerce platform, leveraging a robust logistics system to ensure fast and reliable delivery. Its widespread accessibility and high traffic contribute to initial market expansion and sales stabilization.

TikTok Shop: Targeting the content-driven younger generation, Lunara builds a sales channel that naturally leads to product discovery and immediate purchase through influencer live commerce and short-form videos. This is a key social commerce channel that maximizes Gen Z's sensitivity to trends and virality.

Offline stores (Guardian, Hasaki):Guardian and Hasaki stores in major cities offer offline experiences, enabling customers to try out and test products before making a purchase decision. They also enhance online-offline connectivity, boosting trust and conversion rates.

Omnichannel Sales Management: Integrated management across all channels (official website, Shopee, TikTok Shop, Instagram Shopping, and offline retail) ensures real-time inventory synchronization, consistent pricing, and seamless transitions between purchase paths. For example, customers who tried a product offline can repurchase online, or discover a product on TikTok Shop and learn more about it on the official website, seamlessly connecting the customer journey.

Manufacturing and Production Management Integration: Based on our own production facilities in Vietnam, we provide ODM (Original Design Manufacturer) and OEM (Original Equipment Manufacturer) production, ensuring a stable and high-quality product supply across all channels. We strictly adhere to vegan and cruelty-free certification standards throughout the production process, maintaining consistent brand trust across all channels.

3.4 Customer Relationships

A 24-hour automated chatbot provides delivery tracking and basic consultation services, minimizing customer wait times. Subscribers receive reminder emails, birthday coupons, and regular newsletters to share diverse information, encouraging repeat purchases. Furthermore, the company operates a Vegan Lifestyle Community to provide customers with a sense of belonging to the vegan lifestyle and maximize viral sales.

3.5 Key Resources

Lunara's key resources for product development and sales are as follows: In terms of human assets, we have a research team specializing in vegan certification standards and natural raw material extraction, as well as a digital marketing team targeting local Gen Z consumers in Vietnam. Based on our own production facilities in Vietnam, we will initially utilize ODM to quickly enter the market, while utilizing OEM for our signature products to differentiate our brand. Furthermore, we will secure production and distribution efficiency through management infrastructure and a dedicated logistics warehouse for eco-friendly products. Our intangible assets include vegan and eco-friendly brand trademarks and official organic and cruelty-free certifications for each product, strengthening our brand credibility.

3.6 Key Activities

Our core activities focus on strengthening our identity and competitiveness as a vegan cosmetics brand. First, we will develop and test plant-based, hypoallergenic formulas that meet certification standards through research and development (R&D) of vegan and cruelty-free skincare products, ensuring both product safety and ethical values.

Second, we will maintain a sustainable and reliable production system by conducting regular audits of eco-friendly raw material suppliers and managing the stable supply of raw materials through Supply Chain Management.

Third, Digital Commerce Management optimizes sales strategies across major platforms such as TikTok and Shopee, and maximizes digital sales by planning and operating influencer-affiliated live commerce.

Finally, Sustainability Branding reinforces the brand's eco-friendly image and builds long-term customer loyalty through empty bottle collection programs and environmental campaigns.

3.7 Key Partners

Lunara collaborates with various partners to realize sustainable values. For product delivery, it partners with J&T Express and Viettel Post to provide fast and reliable delivery services across Vietnam. It also collaborates with eco-friendly packaging companies like Kapac and SCG Packaging to use recyclable packaging materials that minimize environmental impact. For raw material sourcing, it secures a stable supply of coconut oil from Peroma Vietnam and Vietcoco, ensuring product quality and ethical practices. For marketing, it collaborates with TikTok influencer Trinh Meow to enhance brand awareness and consumer trust through live commerce and social media content.

3.8 Revenue Streams

E-commerce Platform: This is the most crucial revenue source, securing mass market access and expanding sales through Shopee. Simultaneously, the brand's official website serves as the core e-commerce sales channel, generating high-margin revenue by reducing intermediary distribution fees and leveraging first-party customer data to maximize repeat sales.

Live commerce sales: Through live commerce sessions in collaboration with influencers on TikTok Shop, the brand generates real-time conversion sales revenue by driving content consumption to immediate purchases. This rapid sales growth is driven by high engagement among Gen Z and working professionals.

Offline Retail Distribution: By entering Guardian and Hasaki, major health and beauty stores in Vietnam, the brand expands offline contact points and secures stable wholesale and retail revenue. Its strength lies in trust-based sales, which lead to product trials and subsequent purchases.

Limited edition sales: The brand launches limited-edition seasonal collections, such as the "Lotus Summer Edition," utilizing local Vietnamese ingredients. This maximizes the exclusivity of the products and, through a premium pricing strategy, generates high-value-added revenue.

3.9 Cost Structure

Platform commissions & listing fees consist of sales commissions from Shopee, as well as entry fees and shelf space fees incurred when opening a store with offline retailers like Guardian and Hasaki. Influencer & Community Marketing costs, including KOC collaboration costs like Trinh Meow and the budget for operating a vegan lifestyle community, are also included. R&D expenses for seasonal vegan formulas are also included. Logistics & Fulfillment Costs include shipping costs via J&T Express and Viettel Post, as well as cross-border logistics costs if necessary.

Eco-friendly Packaging Costs consist of biodegradable materials and FSC-certified packaging raw materials procured from Kapac and SCG Packaging. Finally, Personnel & Operational Overheads includes the labor costs of R&D, marketing, and customer service personnel, as well as facility maintenance and various certification maintenance costs.

IV. Business Process

4.1.Company’s Functional Areas

4.1.1. Marketing Department

Core Function	Core Objective	Key Activities & Analytical Tools
Market Research & Strategy	Identify global "Clean Beauty" trends, Vietnamese demand for Cruelty-free products, and opportunities for new product development (e.g., Vegan Physical Sunscreen).	Conduct extensive market analysis and competitor strategic review using Business Intelligence (BI) tools. Adjust the overall strategy to optimize marketing efficacy and strengthen the brand's pioneering position in ethical skincare.

Advertising and Communications	Enhance LUNARA's brand recognition as a safe, gentle, and ethical choice for skin.	Design and execute campaigns across major digital platforms (Google Ads, Facebook, Instagram, TikTok). Focus on product Storytelling and transparent processes. Manage social media channels with educational content on vegan skincare, utilizing Social Listening tools to build loyalty.
Public Relations (PR) & Branding	Build and maintain a positive, trustworthy brand image associated with environmental responsibility.	Develop strategic partnerships with KOLs/Influencers who advocate for green lifestyles. Organize high-commitment community events (e.g., packaging recycling programs). Execute professional Crisis Management to protect brand equity.
Customer Relationship Management (CRM) & Performance Analysis	Build a loyal, sustainable customer base by personalizing the experience (maximizing Customer Lifetime Value - CLV).	Utilize the CRM System to collect and leverage purchase behavior data, consultation history, and product preferences. Perform Customer Segmentation based on detailed variables (skin type, spending level) to design targeted care campaigns.
Pricing and Promotion Strategy	Ensure competitive pricing that accurately reflects the Affordable-premium quality (accessible high-end) of the vegan skincare line.	Determine optimal pricing based on high-quality ingredient costs, market positioning, and competitor analysis. Design promotional programs based on demand elasticity analysis to stimulate demand. Establish loyalty pricing strategies managed through the CRM System.

Table 3: Marketing Department activities

4.1.2. Production Department

LUNARA’s Production Department focuses on transforming natural raw materials into high-quality, safe skincare products, adhering to strict hygiene standards.

Role	Objective	Activities
Product Development Department	To research and create new vegan products, ensuring the stability and efficacy of botanical extracts.	- Develops and tests new product formulas (e.g., a vegan Vitamin C serum formula). - Improves existing formulas to enhance quality, reduce production costs (where possible), and improve the user experience (texture, natural scent). - Collaborates with suppliers to source high-quality, certified natural ingredients (when required).
Quality Control & Ingredient Management	To ensure strict compliance with Vegan, Cruelty-free standards and dermatological safety.	- Input Material Inspection: Ensures the purity, origin, and absence of harmful chemicals or animal-derived ingredients in raw materials. - Finished Product Testing: Conducts microbial testing, pH checks, and temperature stability tests, which are crucial as natural products are more perishable. - Raw Material Inventory Management: Works closely with Sapo Warehouse to track the Batch Number and Expiration Date of each component, ensuring
Safety/Transparency Development	To ensure the absolute safety and transparency of the product. (Replaced "Nutrition" with "Safety/Transparency" to align with the cosmetics industry).	- Collaborates with independent specialists/laboratories to conduct dermatologically tested trials and ensure no harmful ingredients are present. - Ingredient Transparency: Clearly analyzes and publishes the explicit purpose of each ingredient on packaging and the website, enabling customers to easily verify and trust the quality of the vegan product.

Table 4: Production Department activities

4.1.3. Finance

The goal of LUNARA's Finance Department is to manage and optimize financial resources, balancing the high cost of natural ingredients and ethical production processes with the brand's Affordable-premium pricing strategy.

Financial Planning and Forecasting:

The department is responsible for rigorously tracking and managing income, expenses (including the cost of certified clean ingredients, Cruelty-free registration fees, and enterprise system operating costs), as well as net profitability. This ensures the company adheres to budgetary constraints and achieves its financial targets.

It conducts strategic short- and long-term financial planning, proactively forecasting revenue and expenditure. A critical function involves anticipating the inherent price volatility of natural raw materials to provide management with data-driven insights for sound strategic decision-making.

Performance Analysis and Risk Management:

Financial performance progress is assessed using detailed metrics and comprehensive reports on revenue, gross margin, and cash flow, which are automatically recorded and aggregated by the company's centralized management system. The department actively manages key financial risks, including inventory spoilage risk (given the shorter shelf life of natural products), margin compression risk due to input cost fluctuations, and regulatory non-compliance risk related to taxation.

Accounting and Compliance Reporting:

It executes core accounting operations and compliance reporting obligations to ensure timely and credible financial information is available to all stakeholders.

Tax Audit/Inspection Reporting: The Finance Department is responsible for preparing and maintaining complete documentation, financial vouchers, and statutory reports required by tax inspection authorities (e.g., VAT declarations, usage reports for e-invoices, official financial statements). This operational data, accurately compiled from transactions recorded within the enterprise system, is crucial for substantiating the completeness and validity of declared revenue,

expenses, and tax liabilities, thereby ensuring LUNARA's full adherence to prevailing fiscal regulations.

By leveraging operational data provided by the centralized management system, the Finance Department supports the board of directors' decision-making framework from evaluating new investment projects (e.g., product line expansion) to assessing the financial viability of various sales channels (Website, e-commerce marketplaces) ultimately contributing to the company's long-term sustainable development.

4.1.4. Technology (IT) Department

Responsible for managing and maintaining information technology systems that support operational processes, including production and warehouse management software. At the same time, data security is implemented to ensure the safety and security of all information related to operational processes, to prevent risks and protect the company's information assets.

4.1.5. Operations

The Operation Department serves as the backbone of the business by managing the daily flow of orders, inventory, and logistics. Its goal is to ensure smooth coordination between departments so that every customer receives their vegan skincare order accurately and on time, and in the best possible condition, while also helping maintain service efficiency, reducing waste and costs.

a. Production and Warehouse Management

Production Management: Responsible for overseeing the skincare product production process, ensuring that products are manufactured according to quality standards, vegan formulas, and strict hygiene protocols.

Inventory Management: Uses Sapo Warehouse to monitor and manage real-time inventory levels of raw materials (botanicals) and finished products. This is done to ensure there is no shortage during peak seasons and no waste due to expiration.

Optimization: Designs and maintains an efficient warehouse system, specifically ensuring suitable storage conditions for natural cosmetics. Optimizing storage space and processes helps improve work efficiency and reduce operating costs.

b. Supply Chain Management

Raw Material Procurement: Ensures that raw materials (such as green tea extract, aloe vera) are supplied on time and meet the necessary quality standards/certifications, contributing to an efficient and transparent sourcing production process.

Product Distribution: Organizes and manages product distribution closely, ensuring that products reach customers via online channels (website, e-commerce marketplaces) quickly and safely. Distribution data synchronization is managed through Sapo Omnichannel.

c. Customer Service

The customer service function is integrated in the Marketing Department to enhance consistency when solving the customers' problems

Support and Order Handling: Delivers dedicated support services, processing requests for skin consultation, inquiries about ingredients, and handling any arising issues related to orders (e.g., incorrect delivery, damaged product) to ensure customer satisfaction.

Feedback Collection: Collects and analyzes customer feedback (stored in Sapo CRM) to pinpoint areas for improvement. This activity helps improve product and service quality, and better meets the demands of the Clean Beauty market.

d. Logistics and Delivery

Delivery Quality Assurance: After all steps from production and packaging completion, it must be ensured that skincare products are delivered to customers in their best condition, both in terms of sustainable packaging and internal product quality.

Transportation Management: Uses Sapo Express to ensure that goods are transported and delivered to customers in a timely, accurate, and safe manner.

Cost Optimization: This department is a key part of the supply chain optimizing process, which helps increase customer satisfaction and simultaneously realizes cost savings for the business by selecting the most efficient delivery partners.

4.2. Cross - functional Business Process

4.2.1 AS-IS Process Description

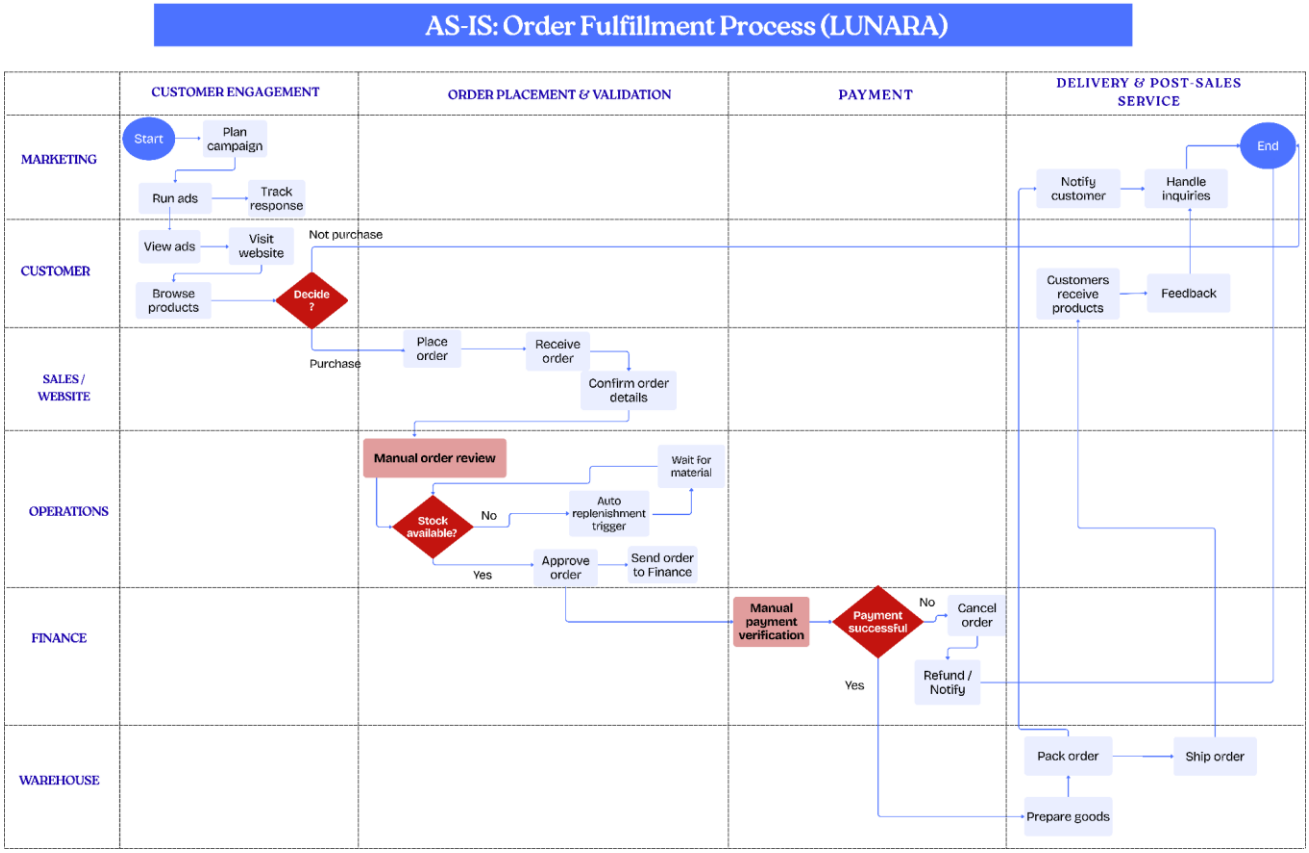


Figure 7: Lunara's As-Is Order Fullfilment Process

The AS-IS swimlane diagram illustrates the current cross-functional order fulfillment process of LUNARA, involving Customer, Marketing, Sales/Website, Operations, Finance, Warehouse, and Customer Service.

The process starts when customers view advertisements, visit the website, browse products, and place an order. Marketing activities such as campaign planning, running ads, and tracking responses support customer engagement but operate separately from the order processing flow.

After an order is placed, the Sales/Website department receives and confirms order details before passing the order to the Operations department. At this stage, the order undergoes manual order review and manual stock checking, which are critical decision points in the process. If stock is unavailable, the Operations team triggers replenishment activities and waits for stock to be available before continuing the process, instead of terminating the order immediately.

Once stock is confirmed, the order is approved and sent to the Finance department for manual payment verification. If payment is unsuccessful, the order is cancelled and the customer is notified with a refund process. If payment is successful, the order proceeds to the Warehouse for goods preparation, packing, and shipping. Finally, Customer Service which is integrated in the Marketing department notifies the customer and handles post-order inquiries, after which the process ends. Overall, the AS-IS process relies heavily on manual tasks, especially in stock checking and payment verification, leading to longer processing times and higher risks of delays.

4.2.2 TO-BE Process Description

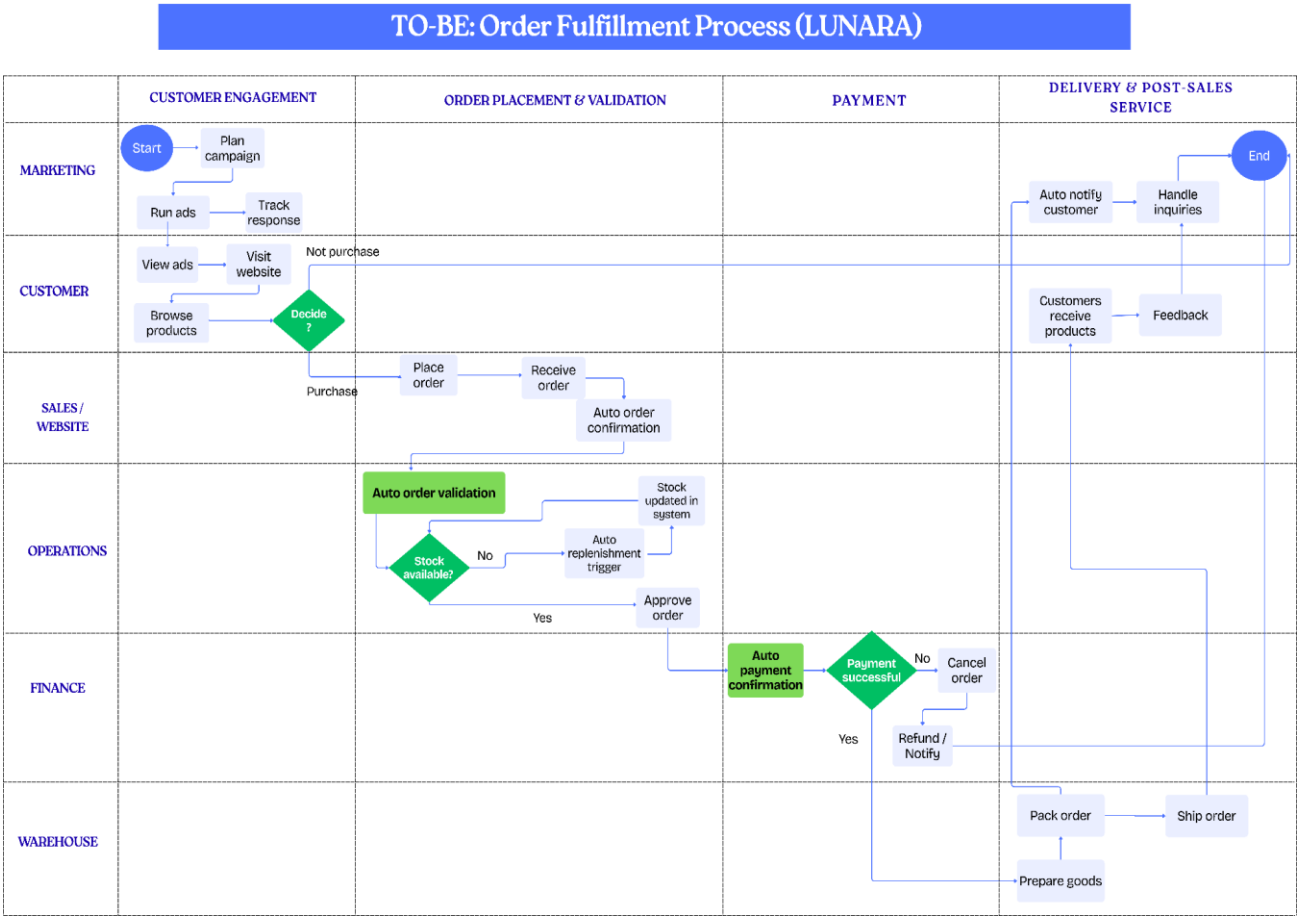


Figure 8: Lunara's TO-BE Order Fulfilment Process

The TO-BE swimlane diagram represents an improved version of LUNARA's order fulfillment process by introducing automation and system integration while maintaining the same functional structure as the AS-IS process.

In the TO-BE process, customer and marketing activities remain unchanged at a high level; however, once an order is placed, the Sales/Website system automatically captures and confirms

the order. The Operations department performs automatic order validation, followed by a system-based stock availability check.

If stock is not available, the system automatically triggers a replenishment process and updates stock information once replenishment is completed, allowing the order to continue without manual intervention. If stock is available, the order is approved and forwarded to the Finance department, where automatic payment confirmation replaces manual verification.

In case of payment failure, the system cancels the order and automatically notifies the customer with refund processing. If payment is successful, the order proceeds to the Warehouse for picking, packing, and shipping. The Marketing department then implements the Customer Service responsibility by automatically notifing the customer and handling any inquiries before the process ends.

The TO-BE process significantly reduces manual handling, improves process speed, and enhances coordination between departments through automation and system integration.

4.2.3 Comparison and Improvement Summary

Comparing the AS-IS and TO-BE processes, the key improvements focus on eliminating manual bottlenecks and enhancing operational efficiency. Manual stock checking and payment verification in the AS-IS process are replaced by automated system-based checks in the TO-BE process. Additionally, the handling of out-of-stock situations is improved by introducing automated replenishment instead of prematurely ending the process.

These improvements help reduce processing time, minimize human error, and provide a smoother experience for both internal departments and customers.

V. Describe Information systems

5.1. Overview about SAPO Flatform

Sapo is recognized as one of Vietnam’s leading multi-channel sales and management platforms. Established in 2008, Sapo has more than 15 years of experience supporting businesses, retailers, and household enterprises in their digital transformation journey. Over this period, the platform has continuously expanded its technological ecosystem to address the growing demand for integrated sales, operations, and data management across multiple channels.

Currently, Sapo is trusted by over 230,000 customers nationwide, including household businesses, small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), retail chains, and large brands operating in various industries such as retail, fashion, beauty and cosmetics, F&B, publishing, and consumer goods. Many well-known Vietnamese brands and retail chains have adopted Sapo as their core sales management system, demonstrating the platform's strong market presence and high level of adoption in Vietnam's retail technology sector.

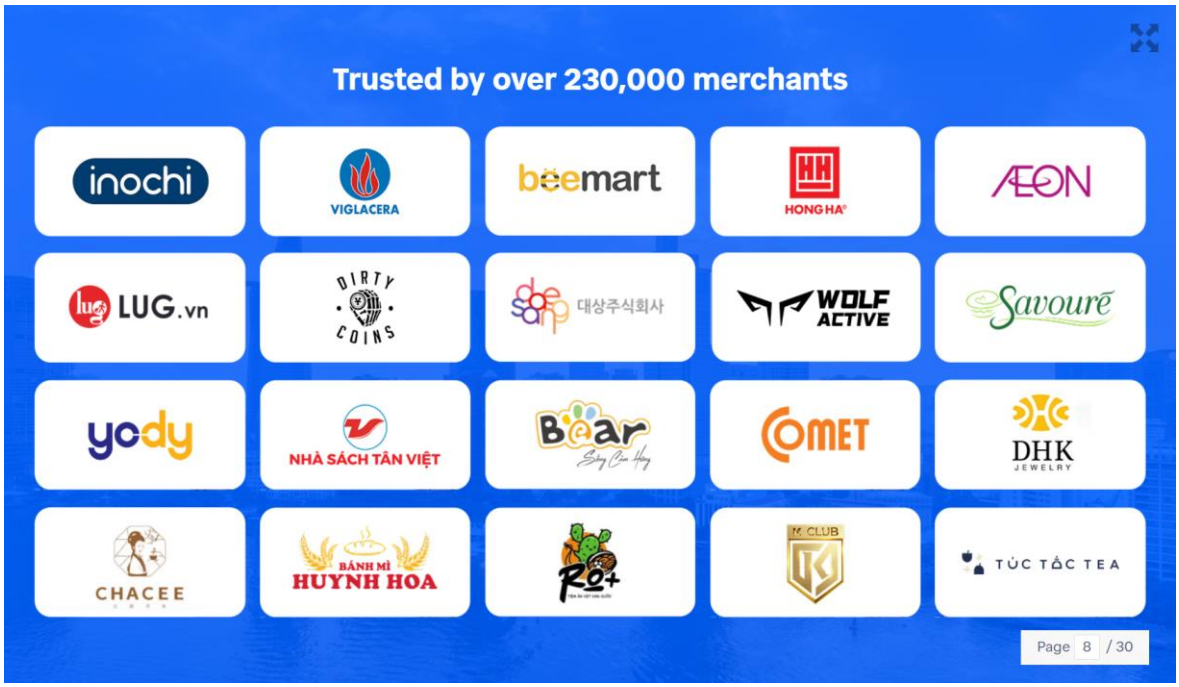


Figure 9: Brands using our platform

Source: Support.sapo.vn

Sapo provides a comprehensive portfolio of solutions designed to support omnichannel business models. Key products include Sapo POS, which enables accurate in-store sales, inventory, and revenue management; Sapo Web, a professional website-building solution integrated with payment gateways, logistics partners, and SEO tools; and Sapo Omnichannel, which synchronizes data across physical stores, websites, e-commerce marketplaces, and social media platforms such as Facebook, TikTok, Shopee, Lazada, and Tiki. In addition, Sapo offers specialized solutions such as Sapo FnB for restaurants and cafés, and Sapo Express, which connects merchants with a nationwide network of logistics providers to optimize shipping costs and delivery efficiency.

In terms of pricing, Sapo adopts a flexible subscription-based model to suit businesses of different sizes and stages of development. Service packages for retail stores typically range from approximately 170,000 VND to 600,000 VND per month, depending on the level of functionality and the number of sales channels supported, while website solutions are offered separately at competitive monthly rates. This pricing structure makes Sapo accessible to small businesses while remaining scalable for growing enterprises.

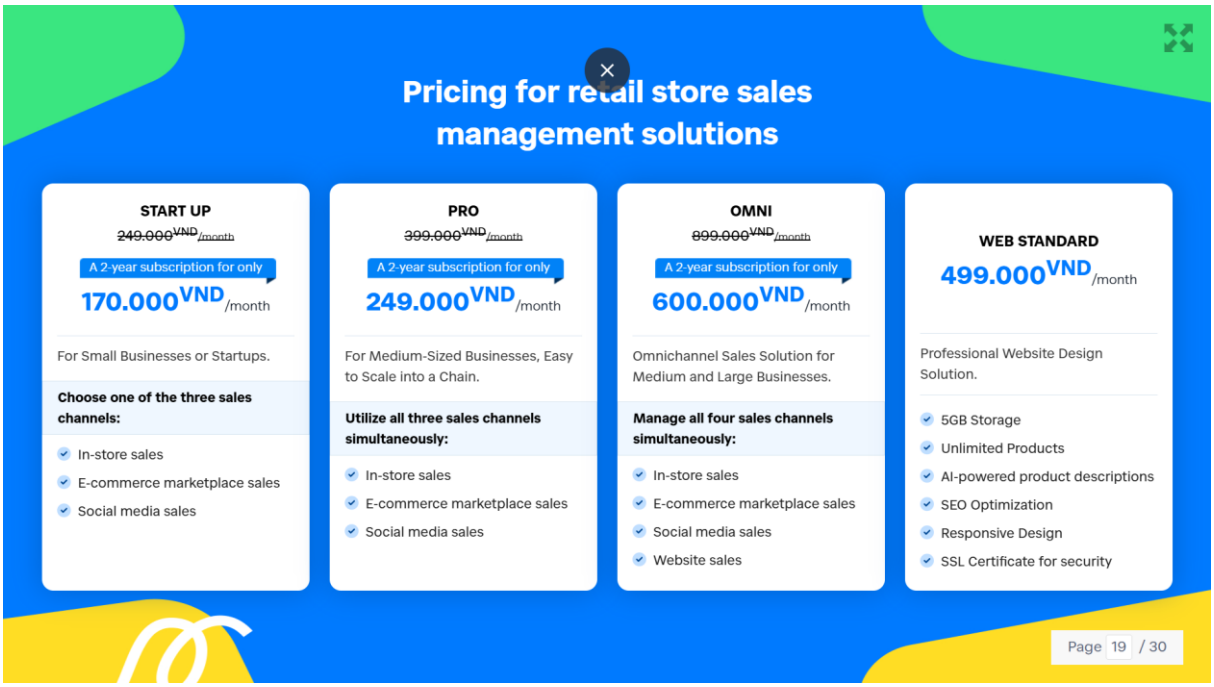


Figure 10: Pricing Plans for Retail Sales Management Solutions

(Source: Support.sapo.vn)

Furthermore, Sapo has built a strong ecosystem with more than 200 integrated partners, covering payment services, logistics, financial institutions, marketing tools, CRM, and ERP solutions. This extensive partner network enhances Sapo's ability to provide end-to-end operational support, from sales and inventory management to payments, shipping, marketing, and financial services.



Figure 11: Partner Ecosystem

Source: Support.sapo.vn

With its large customer base, broad industry coverage, and long-standing presence in the Vietnamese market, Sapo has established itself as a prominent player in the sales management software market. Guided by its vision of becoming Vietnam's leading sales technology platform, Sapo continues to invest in innovation and ecosystem expansion to help businesses improve efficiency, competitiveness, and sustainable growth in the digital era.

5.1.1. Reason why we choose SAPO

Criteria	KiotViet	Haravan	SAPO
Primary focus	POS & offline retail sales	Website & e-commerce	Comprehensive omnichannel sales management
Target users	Small stores, household businesses	Businesses focusing on online sales	SMEs & omnichannel retail chains
POS & in-store sales	Strong, simple, easy to use	Moderate	Strong, deeply integrated

E-commerce website	Limited	Very strong	Strong, integrated with omnichannel
Reporting & data analytics	Basic	Moderate	Detailed, centralized data analytics
Pricing	Low, suitable for micro businesses	Relatively high	Flexible, multiple pricing packages
Scalability	Low to medium	Medium	High, suitable for business growth
Main limitations	Weak omnichannel support	High cost, POS not strong	May be feature-heavy for very small offline stores

Table 5: Comparison between SAPO and other platforms

Based on the comparison above, SAPO emerges as the most suitable platform for Lunara's business model. While KiotViet performs well for small offline retailers and Haravan focuses primarily on website-centric e-commerce, SAPO provides a more balanced and comprehensive omnichannel solution. Its ability to synchronize inventory, orders, and customer data across physical stores, e-commerce marketplaces, and social media channels enables more efficient operations and data-driven decision-making. Furthermore, SAPO's flexible pricing and scalability support business growth without requiring a change of core management systems. Therefore, SAPO is the most appropriate choice for a growing beauty brand operating in a multi-channel environment

5.1.2. Problem – Solution

Lunara faces operational inefficiencies in its order fulfillment process, mainly due to a heavy reliance on manual handling at critical stages such as order review, stock availability checking, and payment verification. Orders must be manually reviewed to confirm inventory status, followed by manual payment verification by the finance team. These steps create process bottlenecks, leading to longer order processing times, higher risks of human error, and delayed customer responses, particularly during peak sales periods and promotional campaigns.

Sapo addresses these challenges by automating the order fulfillment process and integrating key operational functions into a unified platform. The system enables real-time inventory checks and automatically approves orders based on stock availability. Payment

confirmation is also automated, removing the need for manual finance verification and significantly reducing processing time. Once an order is successfully confirmed and paid, it is automatically forwarded to the warehouse for preparation and shipping, while customers receive timely notifications without manual intervention from customer service staff.

By transforming a manual and fragmented workflow into an automated and integrated process, Sapo helps Lunara improve operational efficiency, reduce workload pressure on staff, minimize errors, and enhance the overall customer experience. This solution provides a scalable operational foundation that supports Lunara's long-term growth across multiple sales channels.

5.2. Accurate description of the software function

Sapo is an integrated multi-channel sales management platform that supports businesses in optimizing operations and improving overall business efficiency through a comprehensive digital ecosystem. Instead of focusing solely on sales activities, Sapo provides end-to-end solutions that connect sales, finance, logistics, payments, and enterprise management within a single synchronized system.

At the operational level, Sapo enables businesses to manage sales and inventory across online and offline channels through its core omnichannel system, ensuring accurate data synchronization and efficient order processing. To further support financial management, Sapo Accounting consolidates multi-channel sales data into a unified accounting system, helping businesses manage revenues and financial records more efficiently. In parallel, Sapo Invoice provides compliant electronic invoicing solutions that meet the requirements of Vietnamese tax authorities, reducing administrative complexity and ensuring regulatory compliance.

In terms of payments and financial support, Sapo Pay facilitates cashless payment solutions, improving transaction speed and customer convenience, while Sapo Money offers access to business financing solutions designed specifically for Sapo merchants, helping them address short-term capital needs and maintain stable operations. For logistics and order fulfillment, Sapo Express connects businesses with a wide network of delivery partners, enabling faster order processing, cost optimization, and real-time shipment tracking.

For larger organizations and enterprises, Sapo Enterprise delivers comprehensive digital transformation solutions, integrating sales management with advanced operational, financial, and reporting systems to support scalability and long-term growth. Together, these interconnected solutions form a unified ecosystem that allows businesses to manage sales, finance, logistics, and payments in a centralized platform, enhancing data accuracy, operational efficiency, and strategic decision-making.

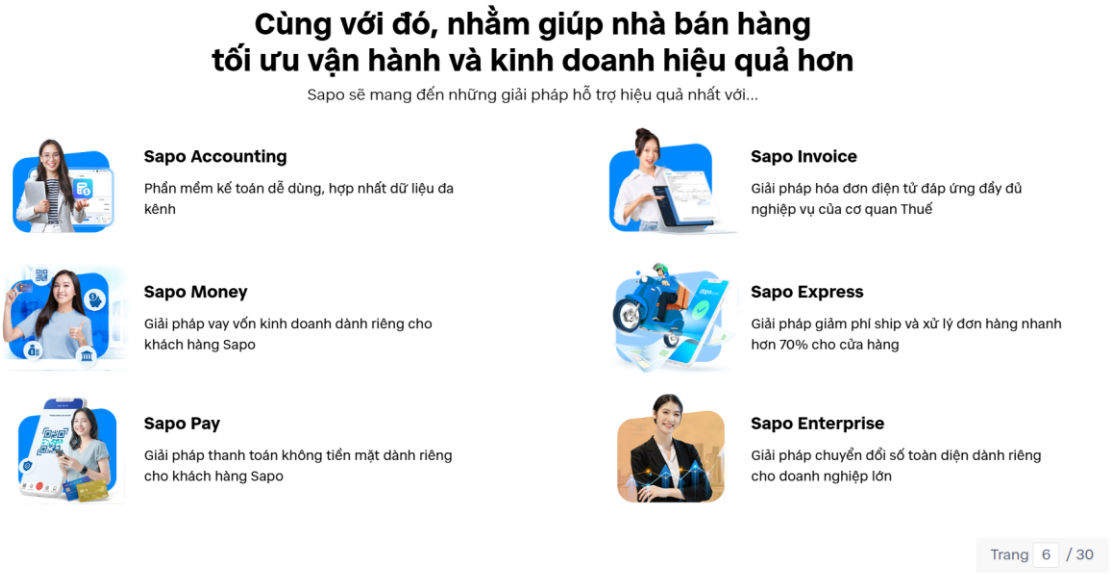


Figure 12: Complementary Services for Business Optimization

Source: Support.sapo.vn

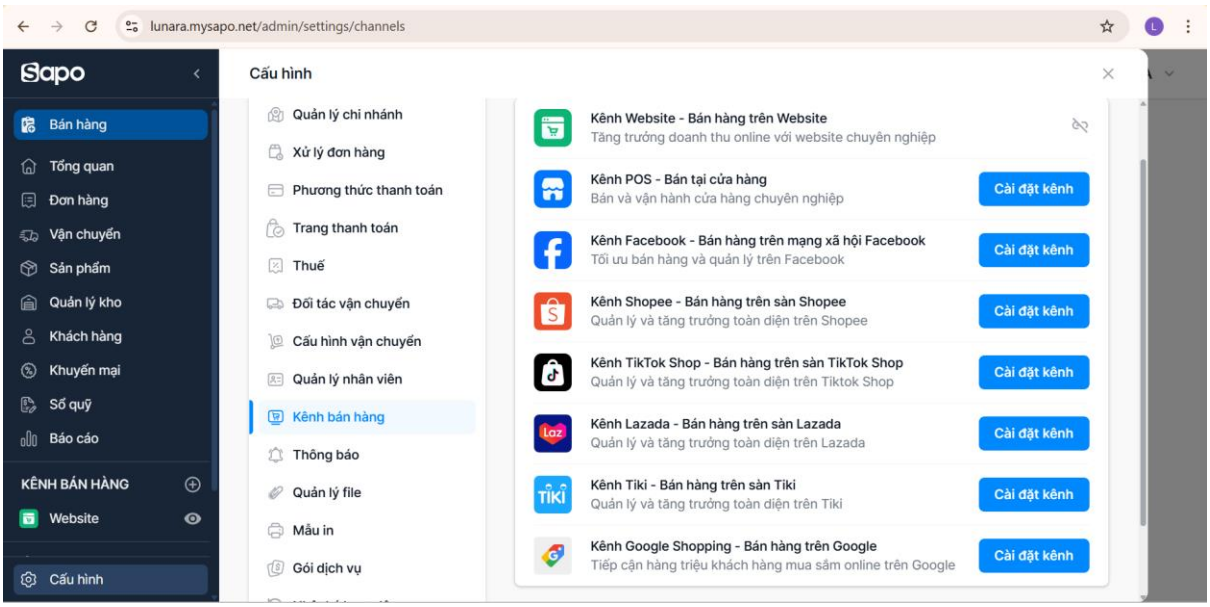
5.3. Feature/ Function

5.3.1. Website sales management

Lunara is a vegan skincare brand that focuses on plant-based, cruelty-free products tailored to young consumers who prioritize safe, sustainable, and ethical beauty choices. Since its establishment, Lunara has identified online sales as the core channel to reach and serve customers nationwide. However, the brand's initial self-built website faced several limitations: the interface lacked professionalism, loading speed was slow, SEO was not optimized, and the platform was difficult to expand with additional online sales features. Moreover, the website was not synchronized with payment gateways or delivery services, resulting in a shopping experience that was not truly seamless. These issues contributed to a high rate of canceled or abandoned orders, making it challenging for Lunara to attract new customers and retain existing ones.

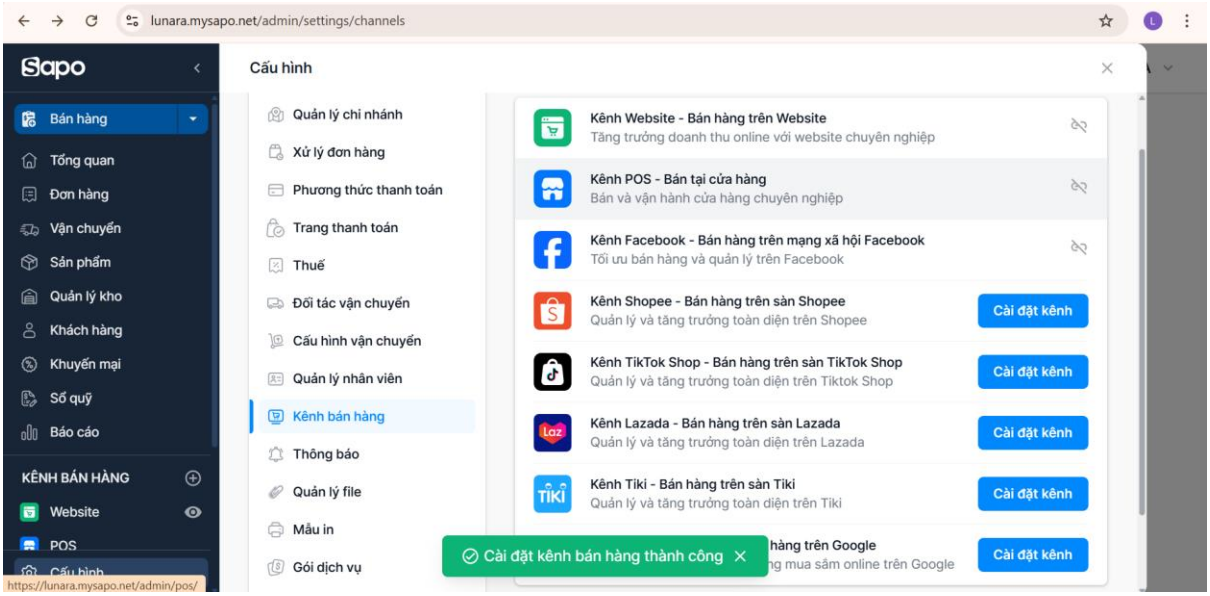
Sapo provides Lunara with a comprehensive sales website management platform. The website is designed with SEO standards, a modern interface, and full compatibility across devices (computers, tablets, and smartphones). Sapo allows Lunara to easily upload products, adjust prices, add detailed descriptions, high-quality images, and skincare tutorial videos. Features such as an intelligent shopping cart, integrated payment gateways (e-wallets, bank cards, etc.), and connections with shipping units (GHTK, Viettel Post…) all contribute to creating a smooth ordering and delivery process. In particular, Sapo supports synchronous data management between the website and other sales channels—such as Facebook and e-commerce platforms—helping Lunara expand its customer base effectively and enhance the overall online shopping experience.

STEP1: Select sales channel → select the plus sign above



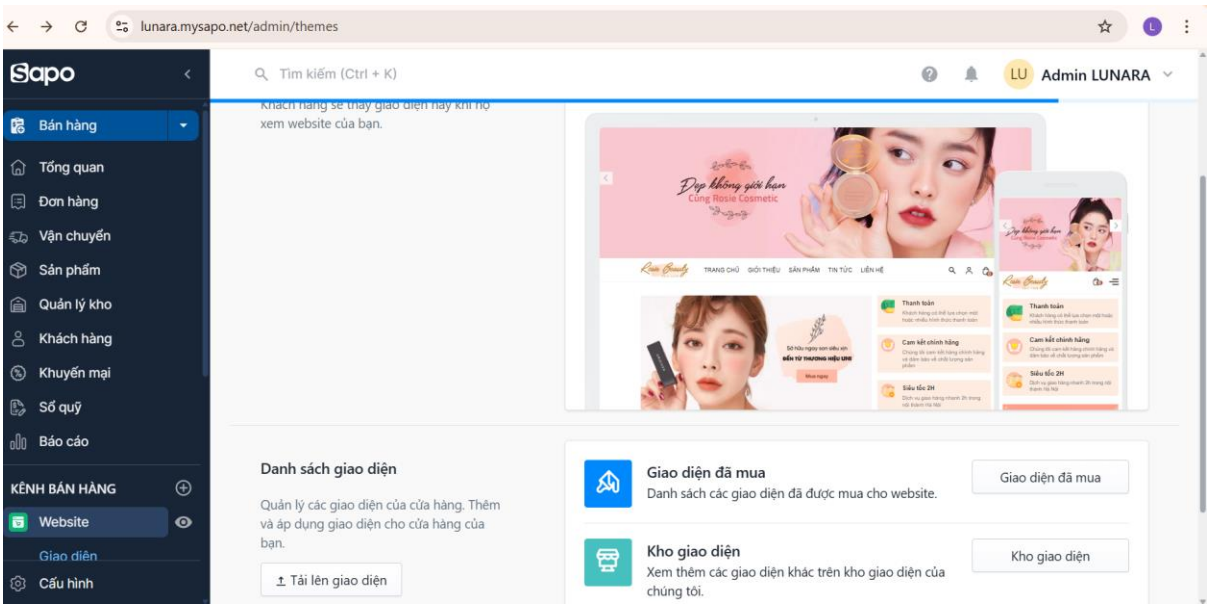
Source: Support.sapo.vn

STEP 2: After clicking on the sales channel, the interface will display related platforms, select the website channel - sell on website —> Click channel settings button After clicking, the interface will display the message "channel installation successful"



Source: Support.sapo.vn

STEP 3: After successfully installing the channel, the website will display the sections "interface; article; content page; menu; domain name; and finally website setup." You can upload purchased interfaces or set up your own website following the steps provided by SAPO.



Source: Support.sapo.vn

Note: This screenshot illustrates a trial interface provided by the platform and does not represent Lunara's actual website.

Sapo brings Lunara a significant advantage in managing its sales website. With a modern, user-friendly, and easy-to-navigate interface, the website designed through Sapo helps Lunara build a professional brand image, creating a positive first impression the moment customers visit. The website is optimized for SEO, supporting improved search rankings on Google and enabling Lunara to reach more customers without having to invest heavily in advertising.

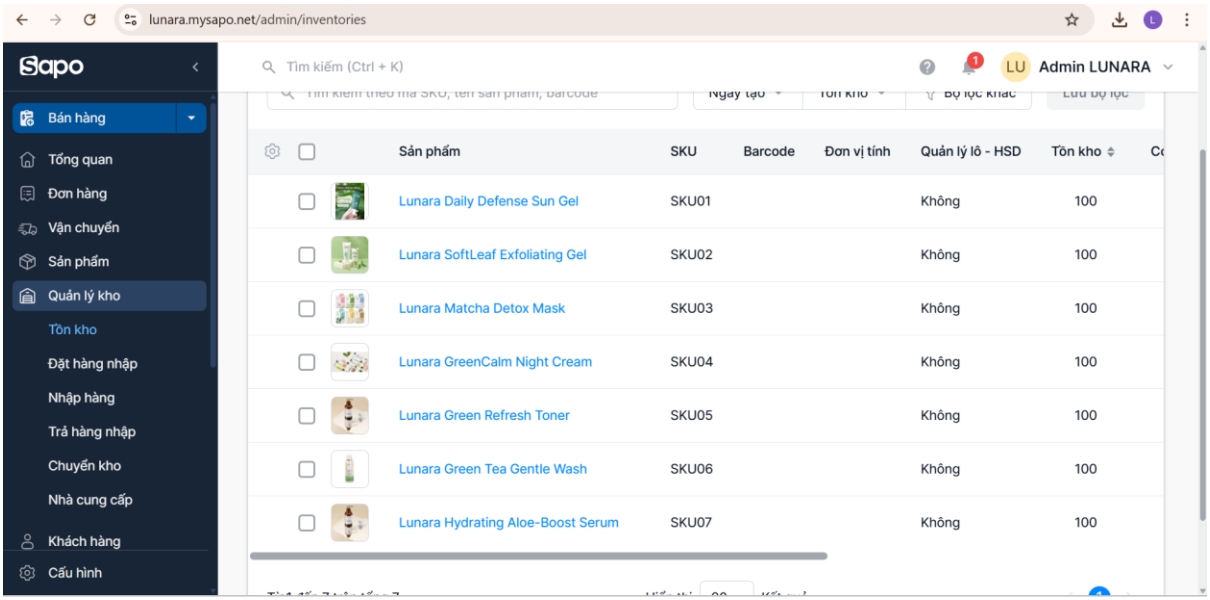
In particular, the system integrates diverse payment methods, connects with multiple shipping partners, and supports multi-channel sales, making Lunara's sales process seamless and efficient. This reduces the rate of cart abandonment and increases the rate of order completion. Such improvements play an essential role in helping Lunara expand its customer base and achieve sustainable growth in sales.

5.3.2. Warehouse Management

With specialized products such as moisturizers, toners, serums, and other plant-based skincare items, Lunara must manage its warehouse with a high level of precision to ensure the quality and safety of products delivered to consumers. Manual management through notebooks or Excel files can easily lead to errors: not knowing the actual inventory, failing to control the expiration date of each ingredient batch, and discrepancies between recorded and actual import–export quantities. As a result, Lunara has encountered issues such as raw materials unexpectedly running out during periods of high demand, excess inventory leading to waste, expired products requiring disposal, increased costs, and a decline in brand reputation.

Sapo's warehouse management feature allows Lunara to monitor import–export–inventory levels in real time, automatically updating whenever a transaction occurs. The system manages each batch according to its expiration date and automatically issues alerts when materials are about to expire, run out, or exceed the allowable inventory level. Its flexible inventory control functions enable quick and accurate reconciliation. Thanks to this, Lunara is always proactive in planning production, purchasing raw materials, and managing product distribution.

STEP 1: Select "Products" → select "Warehouse Management".



Source: Support.sapo.vn

STEP 2: The warehouse management interface appears, you can:

View product version information:

• Product image

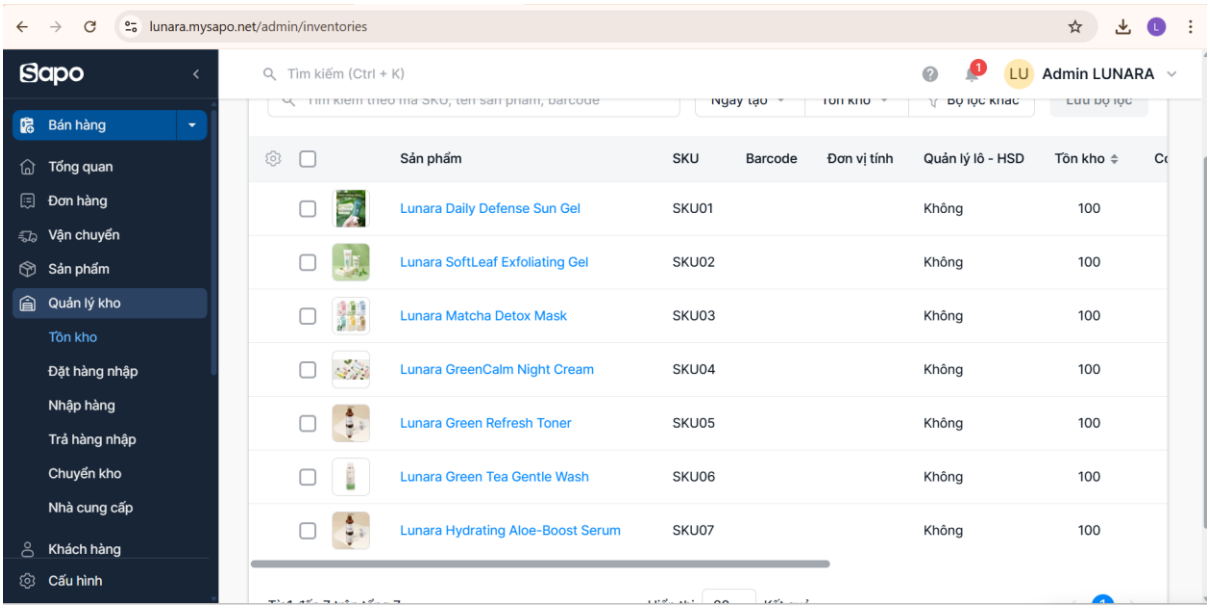
• Product version name

• Available quantity

• Inventory quantity

• Creation date

• Retail price, Import price, Wholesale price



Source: Support.sapo.vn

In the vegan cosmetics industry, warehouse management is always a significant challenge for Lunara, as plant-based skincare products are highly sensitive and easily affected by storage conditions. Natural ingredients such as green tea, aloe vera, chamomile, and matcha are prone to oxidation, reduced effectiveness, or quality changes if stored for too long or if expiration dates are not strictly controlled. Therefore, ensuring freshness and safety for every batch of products is essential to maintaining the reputation of a vegan skincare brand.

Sapo's warehouse management feature enables Lunara to monitor inventory levels in real time, automatically updating quantity changes whenever orders occur, thereby minimizing errors associated with manual tracking. The system allows Lunara to manage each product batch by expiration date and automatically issues alerts when items are approaching expiry or have been stored beyond the optimal duration for natural-based products.

Thanks to this system, Lunara can develop more efficient procurement and production plans, prevent degradation of natural ingredients, reduce product waste, optimize storage costs, and ensure that every vegan skincare product maintains its purity, safety, and natural effectiveness when it reaches customers

5.3.3. Customer management and customer care program

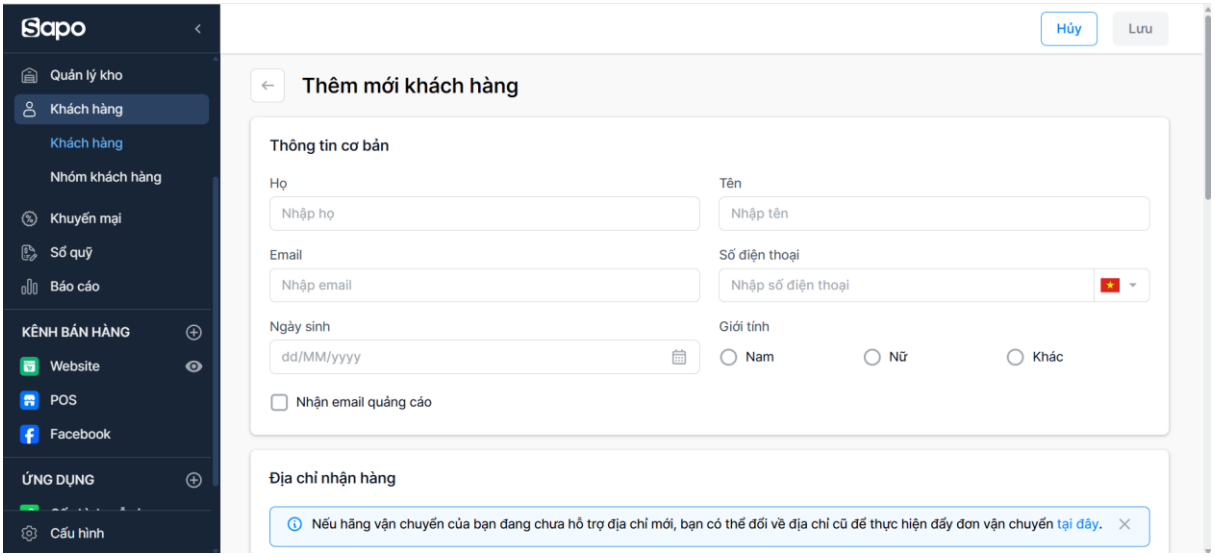
Lunara's customers are primarily young, beauty-conscious individuals who value safe, plant-based skincare and seek personalized product recommendations tailored to their skin type and lifestyle. They often require regular consultation, skincare routine guidance, and educational content about natural ingredients. However, before applying Sapo, Lunara did not have a scientific system to collect, store, or utilize customer data. The information was scattered across different platforms, making it difficult to track purchase history, skin concerns, and individual preferences. As a result, Lunara faced challenges in developing effective customer-care and loyalty programs; activities such as thank-you messages, discount offers, or gifting campaigns were sporadic, unsynchronized, and not impactful. Consequently, Lunara missed opportunities to retain customers and build a loyal community of vegan skincare users.

Sapo supports Lunara by storing complete customer information, including phone numbers, emails, addresses, purchase histories, and skincare behaviors. The system enables Lunara to segment customers based on skin type, concerns (acne, sensitivity, dryness), purchase

frequency, and preferred product lines (e.g., aloe-based or chamomile-based products). Lunara can easily design and automatically send personalized care programs such as birthday offers, loyalty promotions, and discount codes for new customers. Sapo also allows Lunara to track the effectiveness of each campaign, enabling timely and appropriate adjustments.

STEP1: Store customer information

Click on “Customer,” then the system will display the option “Add new customer.” Enter the required information and save.



Source: Support.sapo.vn

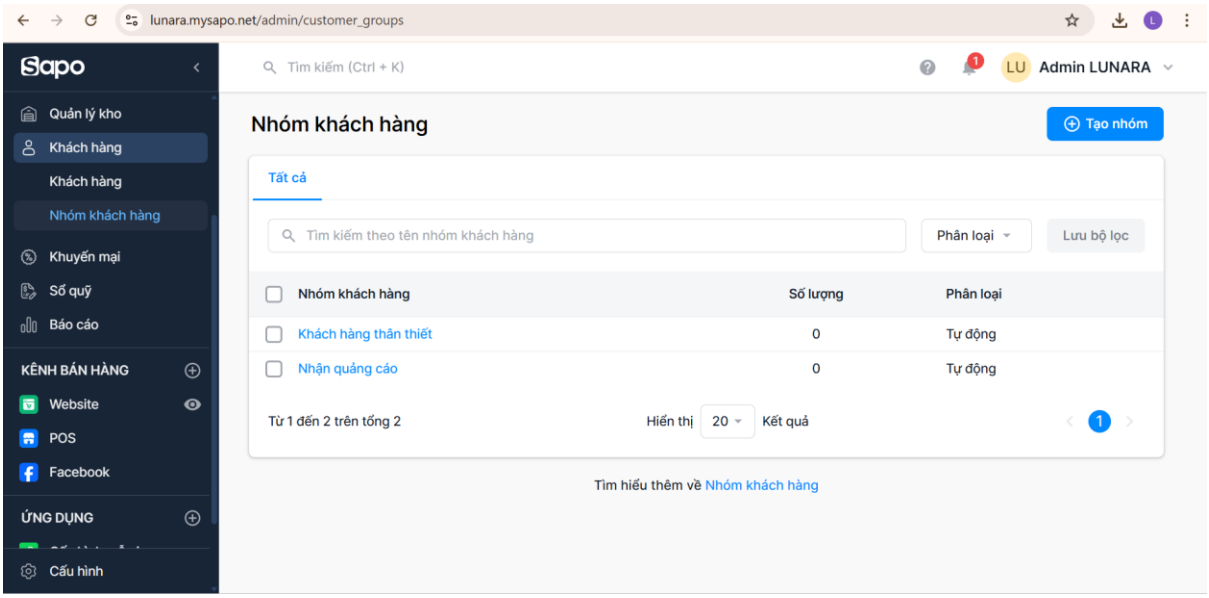
STEP2: Customer data synchronization requires either an email address or a phone number.

To sync client details, pick an identifier (email or phone number) in the synchronization settings. After synchronization, client data will be saved in the "Customer" category for easier administration. Exporting and Filtering High-Score Customers for Loyalty Development. Next, export consumer data and target high-scoring customers to foster loyalty.

STEP3: Managing Loyalty Program Members.

To enroll a customer into Lunara’s loyalty program, navigate to Sapo’s admin page and follow the instructions.

Customers > Customer List > Select Inactive Customers > Click Activate Member



Source: Support.sapo.vn

Customer management and customer care programs are essential features that help Lunara build long-term, sustainable relationships with its consumers. Sapo enables Lunara to store and manage all customer information from purchase history and skincare behavior to individual needs and ingredient preferences, allowing the brand to easily classify customers and approach each group with suitable care programs. Personalized promotional activities such as vouchers, birthday gifts, skincare routine recommendations, or exclusive incentives for loyal customers can be developed effortlessly, creating greater engagement, enhancing the customer experience, and increasing the likelihood of repeat purchases. This plays a crucial role in helping Lunara not only boost revenue but also cultivate a loyal community of vegan skincare users, contributing to the brand's long-term, sustainable development.

VI. Conclusion

This report has analyzed the LUNARA business idea from the perspective of business processes and information systems, demonstrating how a vegan cosmetics startup can be structured and operated efficiently in the Vietnamese market. By examining market conditions, customer segments, and value creation, the study identifies key operational requirements and translates them into a coherent business model supported by digital platforms. The analysis shows that aligning customer needs with standardized yet flexible processes is essential to ensure operational efficiency and service consistency.

In addition, the proposed TO-BE processes and the application of information systems such as e-commerce platforms and CRM tools illustrate how LUNARA can integrate marketing, sales, customer relationship management, and logistics into a unified digital workflow. These systems enable data-driven decision-making, improved customer experience, and continuous process optimization. Overall, the report highlights that the effective integration of business processes and information systems is a critical factor in supporting LUNARA's operational scalability and long-term sustainability within a competitive digital commerce environment.

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